

The Tantra Called the Glorious Vajra-Heart Ornament

Śrī Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra Tantra Nāma · Toh 451 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་རྫོས་ཀྱི་པ་རྒྱ་གཞི་ཅེས་བ་བྱ།

The Glorious Vajra-Heart Ornament Tantra, known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra Tantra and in Tibetan as the Dpal Rdo rje snying po rgyan gyi rgyud, is a tantric text belonging to the Buddhist Vajrayāna tradition. It centers on Vajrasattva, a buddha embodying the essence of body, speech, and mind of all tathāgatas, and unfolds in the classical sūtra style of a teaching witnessed by an assembly that here consists notably of vajra ḍākinīs gathered in a context of tantric union. The text is principally concerned with samaya vows, primordial wisdom, and the activities of these ḍākinī figures, themes characteristic of the inner or higher tantras. It is catalogued as Toh 451 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of tantric texts.

In the language of India: Śrī Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra Tantra Nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Tantra Called the Glorious Vajra-Heart Ornament.

Homage to the glorious Vajrasattva (Skt. Vajrasattva).

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, the essence of body, speech, and mind of all the Tathāgatas, dwelt in the midst of ten women in the manner of the fifth portion. Dwelling in union of vajra and lotus amid a retinue beyond expression, beyond expression, and yet again beyond expression, there were these: the vajra ḍākinī called "Thoroughly Practicing the Samaya Vow"; the vajra ḍākinī called "Fully Accomplishing the Body of Primordial Wisdom"; the vajra ḍākinī called "From Whom Arises Vajra Speech Like an Echo"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Makes Others Know"; the vajra ḍākinī called "Intimately Familiar in One-Pointed Focus"; the vajra ḍākinī called "Superior to All Others"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Provides Support"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Moistens"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Ripens"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Sets in Motion"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Opens the Door"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Is Beautiful with Hāranupūra and the Like"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Is a Singer of Songs Such as Gīta and So Forth"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Bears Fragrance Such as the Essence of Serpents and the Like"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Possesses the Taste of Eating Various Condiments"; the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who Embraces with Various Kinds of Touch"; and the vajra ḍākinī called "She Who

Is Incorporeal and Makes the Three Known" — together with all vajra ḍākinīs equal in number to the dust-motes of Mount Meru. And the great vajra ḍākinīs equal to the expanse of space were as follows: the great vajra ḍākinī called "The Defining Characteristic of Form Dissolving"; the great vajra ḍākinī called "The Defining Characteristic of Feeling Subsiding"; the great vajra ḍākinī called "The Defining Characteristic of Perception Fading"; the great vajra ḍākinī called "Conceptualizing the Defining Characteristic of Formations"; and the great vajra ḍākinī called "The Defining Characteristic of Consciousness Gathered In" — together with all those equal to the expanse of space. By their presence, this buddha-field appeared completely filled, like a pod full of sesame seeds.

Then all those vajra ḍākinīs gathered as one, and with the many mind-arisen clouds of offerings spread before the great vajra ḍākinī Mahāvajradhara (Skt. Vajradhara) — offerings surpassing all those of gods and humans — they paid homage and bowed down, saying these words:

Supreme practice that gathers the three secrets
of all the Tathāgatas —
the Tantra of the Glorious Vajra-Heart Ornament:
we beseech the supreme Guide to teach it.

Then the great Vajradhara, having heard these words of supplication, gazed out over all the ḍākinīs and remained without speaking.

Then all those bodhisattva vajra ḍākinīs likewise spoke these words: "Blessed One, O great vajra ḍākinī of the supremely distinguished qualities of the lordship of all the Tathāgatas — together with your retinue — please do not be displeased with us for wishing you to teach it."

Thereupon Vajradhara the Great, the sovereign of the Tathāgatas, gazed out over the maṇḍala of the retinue and spoke these verses. "The great bodhisattvas have asked well."

Even the buddhas of the lower grounds, if their minds are confused by this text —

what need is there to speak of other bodhisattvas?
This pure nature of reality of the buddhas
is not understood by the childish.
To expound it after granting blessing —
this is the nature of reality of the Teachers.

Then all those vajra ḍākinīs were filled with great joy, and once more they made offerings with an array of worship, prostrated, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, excellent! Excellent! May the sovereign of all the Tathāgatas graciously bestow blessing upon us. May the sovereign of all aspects graciously bestow blessing upon us, teaching the uncommon secret of all the Tathāgatas."

Thereupon, knowing the supplication that had been made by those vajra ḍākinīs, the sovereign of all the Tathāgatas entered into the meditative absorption called "the vajra that blesses all bodhisattvas." From within that state, he drew forth from his own heart this essence called "the Condensed Secret of Body, Speech, and Mind of All the Tathāgatas":

Oṃ āḥ hūṃ samaya vajra.

The very moment it was drawn forth, its rays of light gathered all those assembled vajra ḍākinīs together, drew them into his own heart, and they all remained in the midst of the feminine maṇḍala as if in a swoon.

Then, in order to rouse them, the sovereign of all the Tathāgatas entered into the meditative absorption called "the arising of all ḍākinīs." The moment he entered that absorption, they regained their awareness and remained just as they had been.

Then the sovereign of all the Tathāgatas entered into the meditative absorption called "the arraying of the wheel." The very moment he entered that absorption, all those vajra ḍākinīs were established, each in their own proper place just as it was.

At that time, through the blessing of the Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, all beings dwelling in the expanse of space, however many there were, experienced bliss and mental ease.

Then the Blessed One, the sovereign of all the Tathāgatas, entered into the meditative absorption called "the arising of the tantra of the ornament of the vajra essence." Perceiving the entire realm of sentient beings as evenness itself, he did not breathe in, he did not breathe out, he did not move the body, he did not hold the body still. He neither looked toward nor attended to the Tathāgatas of the three times, nor did he draw near to them. He did not empty out skillful means and wisdom. He did not enter into the fully contradictory. He did not place anyone in higher states. He did not cause the faithless to have faith. He did not tame the untamed. He did not pacify the livelihood of those

living. He did not cause the unceased to cease. He did not stir the unstirred. He did not cause the unexpanded to expand. He did not dispel the confusion of the thoroughly confused. He did not cause the joyful to become joyless. He did not cause the joyless to become joyful. He did not cause the unenraged to become enraged. He did not cause the unpleasant to become pleasant. He did not pacify — and did not tame — the greatly fierce and unruly, the greatly wrathful, gods and asuras, those who lead astray, the greatly malicious, hungry ghosts, flesh-eaters, yakṣas, rākṣasas, those of greatly virulent poison, burning spirits, illnesses, snakes, and all those beings that cause harm.

Then the Blessed One arose from that meditative absorption and, resplendent, performed a dance — smiling, parting the lips, drawing inward, scattering, with beautiful eyes — moving and turning the brow at length,

moving and turning the fingers of the lotus hands left and right in the manner of a garland of dance, stepping and turning the feet upon the surface of the earth, casting forth and drawing back, placing down and lifting up — by the force of these movements pervading this entire expanse of space completely; pervading completely the great element of wind; having pervaded that, pervading completely the great element of fire; then pervading completely the great element of water; then pervading completely the great element of earth. Having pervaded that as well, the Blessed One pervaded completely the awakening mind.

Mountains and all sentient beings,
the various — subtle and coarse —
women, young and old,
men, and those of neither sex,
gods, nāgas, and yakṣas,
spirits, stars, and the Lord of Death,
the lord of waters, Śakra (Indra), and the rest,
and all elements arising and yet to arise:
to all of these the Blessed One, the great bliss,
Samantabhadra, the Vajradhara,
abides having pervaded completely.

This is the first chapter — the chapter on the blessing of the vajra ḍākinīs — from the tantra called the Glorious Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra.

Then, furthermore, what is to be taught:
the secret mantras that accomplish

the highest of all karmic deeds
shall now be explained.
Listen with one-pointed mind.

Oṃ ākāro mukhaṃ sarvadharmāṇām ādyanutpannatvāt. This is the mantra of the torma offering.

A Ā. I Ī. U Ū. E Ai. O Au. A Aḥ. These are the vowels, representing women.

Ṛ Ṝ. Ḍ Ḍ̄. These represent those of neither sex.

Ka Kha Ga Gha Ṇa. Ca Cha Ja Jha Ña. Ṭa Ṭha Ḍa Ḍha Ṇa. Ta Tha Da Dha Na. Pa Pha Ba Bha Ma. These are the consonants, representing males.

Ya Ra La Va — these are the elements.

Śa Śa Sa Ha — these are fear and so forth.

Kṣaḥ — this resounds as the dharmadhātu.

Vajradhṛk Hūṃ. Jinadhik Bhrūṃ. Ratnadhṛk Āṃ. Ārolīk Dzraiṃ. Prajñādhṛk Khāṃ. These are the five great ḍākinīs.

Dveṣarati Māṃ. Moharati Lāṃ. Rāgarati Pāṃ. Vajrarati Tāṃ. These are the vajra ḍākinīs as supports and so forth.

Kṣitigarbha Kṣīṃ. Vajrapāṇi Dzrī. Gaganagarbha Khāṃ. Lokeśvara Gāṃ. Nīvaraṇaviṣkambhin Kāṃ. Samantabhadra Sāṃ. These are the vajra ḍākinīs of sacred commitment and so forth.

Rūpavajra Dzaḥ. Śabdavajra Hūṃ. Gandhavajra Bāṃ. Rasavajra Hoḥ. Sparśavajra Khāṃ. Dharmadhātuvajra Rāṃ. These are the vajra ḍākinīs as adornments and so forth.

Yamāntakṛt. Prajñāntakṛt. Padmāntakṛt. Vighnāntakṛt. Ṭakkīrāja. Nīladaṇḍa. Mahābala. Acaleka Ṇa Hūṃ. Sumbha Ni Hūṃ. Cakravarti Ni Hūṃ Bhūṃ. These are the vajra ḍākinīs as Yamāntaka and so forth.

Varijina Bhrūṃ. Tejoskambha Bhūṃ. Mantracakra Bhūṃ. Vardhana Bhūṃ. Visaraṇa Bhrūṃ. Virajina Bhrūṃ. Karobhava Bhrūṃ. These are the vajra ḍākinīs as Uṣṇīṣavijayā and so forth.

Hūṃ Hrīḥ Kha — this is the space vajra ḍākinī.

Oṃ medhine vajrī bhava vajrabhavanbha Hūṃ — this is for the earth.

Oṃ vajraprākaraṇa Hūṃ Bāṃ Hūṃ — this is for the enclosure.

Oṃ vajrapañjara Hūṃ Yāṃ Hūṃ — this is for the net.

Oṃ vajravitāna Hūṃ Khāṃ Hūṃ — this is for the canopy.

Oṃ vajraśarajala Trāṃ Sāṃ Trāṃ — this is for the arrow.

Oṃ vajrajvālānalārka Hūṃ Hūṃ Hūṃ — this is for the light.

Oṃ śūnyatājñānavajrasvabhāva ātmako 'haṃ — this is the mantra of emptiness.

Oṃ dharmadhātusvabhāva ātmako 'haṃ — this is the mantra of the dharmadhātu.

Oṃ sarvatathāgatakāyavākcittavajrasvabhāva ātmako 'haṃ — this is for the blessing of the body and so forth.

Vajrasamayāsūtraṃ māti krama Hūṃ — this is for drawing the lines.

Vajracitrisamaya Hūṃ — this is for laying out the colors.

Hūṃ Hāṃḥ Ādzhai — this is for the descent of wisdom.

Vajrakīlaya muṅgara ākoṭaya Hūṃ Phaṭ — this is for the striking with the ritual dagger.

And so on — the infinite and boundless,
difficult to find in all three worlds:
however many assemblies of mantras there are,
all of them expanded beforehand —
those that are secret, those that instill awe,

Śrī Cakrasaṃvara and the others — I have fully explained these, together with their rites. May they be understood by the yogi through realization. This is the second chapter, the mantra chapter, from the glorious tantra Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra.

Then one should draw the maṇḍala, the awe-inspiring city of the ḍākinīs. One who knows the ritual of action should perform all the rites in the appropriate manner. Twenty-five cords, produced from insentient material, are made so as never to generate blessing — rendered permanent — and with these one lays down the lines.

Four-sided and with four gates, adorned with four toraṇa arches, draped with silk and garlands of flowers, richly furnished with four cords: at every corner one places moons, jewels, and vajras. One who understands the distinctions of rites, and who is endowed with intelligence, places the mudrās. In the center

one draws the awesome vajra resembling an indranīla sapphire. In the east, a white eight-spoked wheel. In the south, a green nine-cornered jewel. In the west, a red eight-petaled lotus. In the north, one draws a blue sword.

At the fire quarter, a blue wheel. At the quarter of falselessness, a red utpala lotus. At the wind quarter, a red lotus. At the quarter of the Lordly One, a yellow utpala. At the eastern gate, a vajra hammer. At the southern gate, a vajra staff. At the western gate, a lotus stalk. At the northern gate, an open vajra. These are to be placed by one who is skilled in the application.

For the twenty-five aspects, the pigments too are to be visualized, and the five colored powders and so forth are to be applied in due sequence.

Then, the vase to be held: one whose root is free of dark spots, with a stable base, long neck, and spreading lip — prepared with just as many divine measures — is correctly wrapped at the throat with cloth. Made beautiful at the mouth with blossoms, filled to the full with the five precious medicinal seeds and fragrant water, the vase is to be praised with utterances of acclaim.

The victorious vase for the center of the maṇḍala: four for the goddess-sovereigns of the maṇḍala, four vases for the gods, and the vases for the directional gates — all these are to be recited over by the one who performs all rites. With a bundle of kuśa grass one scatters them with great blessing upon all who enter. Then, having offered the ritual fee and torma offerings, these are all arranged in the outer hall. On the right side the Victors are invited.

Then, with the application of intention for the resident deities, one is to meditate. The application without mudrā does not bless embodied beings. A girl of beautiful form, adorned with the freshness of youth, one who has received empowerment and whose body has reached full bloom, a consort adorned completely with ornaments — through her one emanates the wheel. To her one presents offerings of a hundred and more lamps, and one praises her. Urine, excrement, blood, and lymph are placed in a great conch shell and offered to the deities.

Then one leads the disciples into the supreme city of the ḍākinīs, with the words: "Having truly attained vajra wisdom, I, into this supreme maṇḍala palace of all Tathāgatas, hereby lead my disciples."

Then by that disciple too, flowers are scattered with this mantra: Oṃ prāṭiccha vajra hoḥ.

Then with these words the face covering is removed: "Today, through the force of faith, you may gaze upon this maṇḍala here and now. You have been born into the family of buddhas. You are blessed by mantra and mudrā. All accomplishments are gathered in perfection. The supreme commitment will be fulfilled. The supreme sport of vajra and lotus — know it as the very nature of mantra."

Pāśa vajra.

"Those for whom the flower falls in secret — that very deity, precisely, is given as that one's practice, and one accomplishes it with that very assiduity."

The five nectars are poured from a great conch shell: "If you transgress the commitment, this water of hell will burn you. If you guard the commitment, this is the water of vajra nectar, accomplishment's own drink — drink it."

Vajra udkāṭha.

Then, to the sinless disciple, the master gives all the vows and commitments of all buddhas —

— should be proclaimed just as it is.

This is the third chapter, the chapter on the painted maṇḍala, from the Glorious Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra Tantra.

Then, furthermore, what is to be explained:

The supreme rite of empowerment —
whoever performs it perfectly
will himself be accomplished as a buddha.

The master, possessed of all the defining marks,
who truly knows and understands the tantra,
who knows the rite of secret knowledge
in those ten and others —

with diligence let him properly take hold of the disciple.

The disciple is one who is devoted and faithful to the master,
who cultivates virtue, makes offerings to the deities,
and is endowed with the quality of generosity.

Then the disciple, for his part, rises and touches
his head to the master's feet.

The sovereign lord, excellent in bliss and vow,
is beautifully clothed and adorned.

Above, a parasol is set as a canopy.
With parasol, victory banner, and pennant,
with shoes, the brahman's thread,
with bracelets and belt,
and with many auspicious verses —
to the sinless disciple
the master confers the empowerment.

First, with the vase of complete victory,
then with the four goddesses,
and with the fourth of all the deities —
with auspicious verses, with melody and song,
and with the ringing of the vajra-bell,
the maṇḍala of the Protector is vividly present,
filled to the brim like a vessel full of sesame.
The Victor, taking up the vase, confers
the empowerment itself upon that one —
know that to be the very maṇḍala itself.
Having reflected thus,
the defining marks of phenomena are then to be shown.

Then a pleasing young woman,
well-trained and accomplished in empowerment,
beautifully adorned and splendid with ornaments,
is sought and offered to the master.
Then that royal disciple
is empowered with the union
of the assembled secret, the inner hidden gathering —
the engagement of the secret.
Drawn from vajra and lotus,
thick, applied edge to tip,
place the vajra at the knee.

"Oh, what bliss — great bliss!
Oh, the commitment — speak bliss!
Oh, bliss — take bliss!"

This, called the secret empowerment,
is the supreme method of that conferral.

Alternatively, one who is supremely devoted,
of fine form and joyous in practice,
is offered, through the union and custom, to the master.
The master, having blessed the goddess,
gives her in service of that practice.
Having received her, one assembles the host of diligences,
does all just as it was declared,
and through the rite that pleases
one's own deity, the buddhas,
and all the hosts of bodhisattvas,
one examines the mind.

The bliss that arises directly and spontaneously —
what others are unable to proclaim anywhere —
that domain of realization is great bliss.
That must be offered to the master.

To other masters likewise,
offer whatever fees one wishes.
Whatever the master desires even slightly,
imagined in his mind — that offer.
Out of fear of transgressing the commitment,
with diligence offer it just so.

The supreme offering-object of the master
is distinguished into five by the distinction of lineage,
or divided into classes beginning with the vase empowerment —
or there are three.

One's own mother and the lion throne —
these are the supreme gift and belong to the buddha-lineage.
Gold, elephant, jewel,
and offering one's sister to the master —
these belong to the vajrasattva lineage,
and that gift is the supreme of gifts.

A chariot and a horse most excellently adorned,
one's own wife offered —
various precious things, pure —
that gift belongs to the jewel lineage.

A lovely pearl garland,
a maiden adorned with jewel-like adornments,
offered to the master —
that gift belongs to the lotus lineage.

A king and a sovereign lord,
a wife, a magical mount and so forth,
elephant and horse most excellently adorned —
the lord of all the Tathāgatas,
offered with fervent devotion to the master —
these various gifts belong to the vajra lineage,
and that gift is the supreme of gifts.

These four, together with the distinction
of what changes and what does not change,
are to be known as three
by the intelligent vajra disciple offering to the master.

Now if one desires all bliss —

one should offer with a mind of faith and devotion. If something thought of in the mind is not offered, or if something pledged is not given, one will certainly be reborn in one of two states — as a hungry ghost (preta) or in a hell realm — and be utterly ruined. Therefore, having offered all those things in full, one should present one's entreaties earnestly.

"I have entered into the maṇḍala of the great vajra maṇḍala.
I have entered into the maṇḍala of the great maṇḍala of engagement.
Today I behold the maṇḍala of the great maṇḍala of engagement.
I receive empowerment into the maṇḍala of the great secret maṇḍala."

Then the master, for his part, should bestow the empowerment upon that disciple, adorned with incense and garlands of flowers, and should examine him carefully and thoroughly. To the first, the vase empowerment is given; to the second, the secret empowerment; the third is the wisdom-gnosis empowerment; and the fourth is the gnosis empowerment itself — all received from the master.

This is the fourth chapter of the Glorious Vajra-essence Ornament Tantra, the chapter on empowerment together with its benefits.

Now, by the method through which the meaning of the five families becomes one's own benefit, all-good Samantabhadra — for the supreme bliss of others,

the sādhaṇa of Vajrasattva is explained.

In a delightful and secluded place, dwelling at ease, having pervaded with the mind all of space, contemplate and reflect: "How wondrous! All beings throughout every world are afflicted on all sides by the phenomena of suffering. May those sentient beings whose awakening mind has degenerated arise from all of that" — thus having pledged, the mantra practitioner places this on the crown of the head.

AḤ. The six subtle particles of mind, dispersed into all ten directions, cleansed of all the objects of phenomena — the mind is utterly stainless and pure. The mind of the past and the mind of the future, and even the mind of the present, have no referent. In the non-dual, there is no non-duality. Even what is called "space" has no fixed location. Having thus examined everything in this way, all beings are utterly empty. This itself is the immaculate yoga. Contemplate one's own mind as without any substantial thing. In such a state of being, since there are no things at all, what are all these various sufferings? Meditate on sentient beings whose awakening mind has degenerated as arising from this.

Nevertheless, driven by the power of former aspirations, one should sing a song rich in vowel-elaborations. The precious awakening mind, being dull, appears to be aroused by the Sugatas (the buddhas, the "well-gone ones").

ŚŪNYATĀ-TI-YOGA-PĀDAṂ SVĀHĀ. PRABHAVĪ ĀKĀŚA-TAMĀ-PAGATA-SAMAYA.
UPATAPAYANTI SUGATA SUGATE GATI ŚRĪ VAJRA SVĀHĀ. PŪPUSTAṂ HĀṂ.

Having abandoned all conceptual thought, in a mind of meditation free from thought, pristine and without elaboration, arouse the suchness of the mantra, and contemplate it in the form of the syllable HŪṂ. When one comes to be governed by meditative absorption — since it is attained through that very meditation — the noble one abides in the expanse of space. There the assembly of awakening mind is gathered, and the yogin, having reflected on everything with the mind, should contemplate it in full detail.

By the syllable BHRŪṂ, the divine abode is evoked: adorned with vajras and jewels, with archways, gateways, columns all festooned with silk garlands, foursquare with four gates, hung with nets of bells, constantly bedecked with pendant ornaments, mirrors, and garlands of flowers. At its center is a lion throne, beautifully adorned with eight lions. By the power of aspiration, all of these are the mighty bodhisattvas. In the east is the seat of the great spreading bull; in the south, the excellent horse throne; in the west, as it is

said, the peacock; and likewise in the north, the garuḍa (the sky-eagle).

Contemplate Akṣobhya (the Wrathful Unmovable), with a face that is dark blue, white, and red, the vajra mudrā at his heart, his dark blue color vivid and excellent, a jeweled wheel on his right, a sword and lotus on his left — he who shakes every world-realm entirely. The practitioner of observances should contemplate three faces.

The first is emptiness —

The second is signlessness, and the third is wishlessness — let the wise recognize these as faces. Contemplate the six arms always blazing, bearing various weapons. From meditative equipoise upon the lotus, the wisdom mudrā at the heart — contemplate this as the dwelling of the center. He abides in the vajra cross-legged posture.

Contemplate the dwelling of the east: the mantra-practitioner Vairocana, the Mighty One, with faces of white, dark blue, and red; the wheel mudrā at his heart; a blazing vajra and other radiant lights; a jeweled vajra on his right; a sword and lotus on his left. The yogin should contemplate him always, adorned with a crest-jewel and crown ornaments.

Ratnagarbha, the Jeweled Protector, in the south: faces of yellow, dark blue, and white; the jewel mudrā at his heart, appearing like emerald. On his right, a wheel and sword; on his left, a vajra and lotus. The yogin should contemplate him always, causing a rain of jewels to fall.

In the dwelling of the west, place Amitābha, Boundless Light: faces of red, dark blue, and white, in color like a ruby lotus. The lotus mudrā at his heart; a vajra and jewel on his right; a wheel and sword on his left. Contemplate him in meditative equipoise upon the lotus.

In the dwelling of the north is Amoghasiddhi: faces of green, dark blue, and white; the sword mudrā at his heart, equal to a garland of flames. A lotus and vajra on his right; a wheel and jewel on his left. He dwells at the center of a lunar maṇḍala. Contemplate him in the dwelling of the north.

For the mantra-practitioner's contemplation of the six arms: in the manner of the mudrā of Vairocana, with three white faces — contemplate fully for that purpose.

Contemplate also Māmākī: resembling an utpala lotus, with a dark blue hue; three faces, six arms; she holds the supreme mudrā of Akṣobhya. She is the mantra of the family of passionate attachment, through passion.

Three faces, six arms, virtuous: contemplate the ground of union as white — she bears the mudrā of ruby-lotus.

Tārā is of yellow color, beautifully adorned with graceful ornaments. Contemplate her fully with three faces and six arms — she bears the mudrā of the Unobstructed King.

At the four gates, place the gatekeepers: contemplate the wrathful ones at the gates. The great wrathful one, Yamāntaka, the destroyer of Death, is likewise undefeated by others. Hayagrīva, who is difficult to overcome, and the wrathful one who is the churning of ambrosia — contemplate these. All of them have three faces and are fierce, crushing fiercely. Dark blue, yellow, red, and green are their colors. They hold various weapons and likewise carry skull garlands. They terrify all demons.

Yakṣas, rākṣasas, and pramathas; buffalo, lion, tiger — and those who ride bulls — these are the four. Wrathful and frowning with transforming expressions, the wrathful ones draw all their eyes together. By these mantras, contemplate Yamāntaka and the rest.

In accordance with the suchness of the mantras, having accomplished the mantra-practitioner's maṇḍala, contemplate the bodhisattvas — Kṣitigarbha and the others — as dwelling there.

This very body, speech, and mind: contemplate the mind as entering into the supreme syllable HŪṂ. Akṣobhya himself is the great being. Having arisen along the path of the sense faculties, adorned with a pure and luminous maṇḍala, being one and becoming one — examine it in an instant. "You are called Vajrasattva" — so he is praised and more.

Then, absorb Vairocana and the others fully into one's own heart. Form in its intrinsic nature is Vairocana, the Mighty One. Feeling is Ratnagarbha, the Jeweled Protector. Boundless Light is perception. Formations are, without doubt, Akṣobhya. As for the five aggregates, they are the five Tathāgatas.

Contemplate those mantras as residing there, in the intrinsic nature of the earth element. Then invite in the eye. What the yogin contemplates with the mind abides, one should think, in a state of expansion. Māmakī is of the nature of the water element, because moisture and blood flow through the body — so the yogin contemplates with the mind, and the body becomes enlarged. In the intrinsic nature of the fire element, White Garment is invited in as well. She who abides pervading everything becomes the very lights therein. Tārā should

be contemplated as residing there in the intrinsic nature of the wind element. The winds are transformed into the five kinds, and likewise the swift-as-mind supernormal powers are accomplished. The Mistress of the Vajra Expanse enters into the pure intrinsic nature of space. In the hollow interior of that body, with the mind that cultivates the qualities of one's own awareness, through the yoga of the expanse of space and the practice of the illusory buddha, one proceeds to offer Mount Meru as one's pure self, according to whatever one wishes.

Kṣitigarbha, the great self — the buddha's eye, which is that self — entering in the direction of the eye, becomes forever the miraculous eye. Vajrapāṇi, the great self — by the practice joined with the ear-consciousness, that which knows all sounds becomes, in just the same way, the ear-consciousness itself. Ākāśagarbha, the great self — by the practice joined with the nose-consciousness, one knows the very nature of the buddha's breath, and that too becomes its own essential nature. The one deeply enamored of Avalokiteśvara, the Lord of the World — by the practice of the vajra tongue, through experiencing the reality of taste, one becomes that in a single instant. The wise one, bearing the name that dispels all obscurations, dispels all afflictions and destroys even the secondary afflictions as well. As in the manner of a mirror — arising in the mode of support, like the appearance of a reflection, through the practice of that reflection — in an instant one becomes that.

The Blessed One Vajrasattva, with sixteen aspects — through that practice one is blessed, and by mantra it is drawn into the mind. The wrathful one's iron hook at the shoulder is the second, like a lasso. The chain-link joining, third, is placed so that the victory banner pervades throughout. Thus the meanings fully enter in: oneself as the essential nature of all buddhas, endowed with the vajra mudrā, the left hand holding a bell at the hip — Vajrasattva comes to abide there. In the form of the great white yogin, with a head of white, blue, and red, through the practice joining oneself with emptiness and so forth, one is called Vajrasattva.

For one who is attracted to the vajra mudrā:

Oṃ sarva tathāgata anuragaṇa vajra svabhāva ātmako 'haṃ.

For the worship of the buddhas:

Oṃ sarva tathāgata pūja vajra svabhāva ātmako 'haṃ.

Visualizing one's own previous maṇḍala before one, in the sky — making it one through the pervading practice — one recites it while contemplating it as before, as the previous maṇḍala. The peerless Blessed One enters in, is bound, and abides, holding the vajra mudrā at the heart. In the right hand is a precious wheel, and in the left a lotus and sword. In just this way, as the nature of those three, recite as many times as one is able. Then, drawing them with the mind of the hook, absorb them all into the heart. While remaining in the state of equanimity, whatever movement the body makes and whatever flows forth as speech — all of that becomes mantra and mudrā.

Through the practice of constant meditation, there is no other bodhisattva for that one. The goddesses too hold to the yogin who embodies form. Whatever faculties have come to function as the path — their own respective natures, through the practice of perfect equanimity, make oneself into the supreme deity.

This is the fifth chapter, the chapter on deities, from the tantra called the Glorious Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra.

Then all the Tathāgatas and all the bodhisattvas together made supplication to the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, the Tathāgata of vajra body, speech, and mind, with one harmonious voice, in unison of words:

O Blessed One, Tathāgata of all,
precious and stainless gnosis —
the peerless jewel of awakening mind,
please, we beseech you, expound it.

Then the Blessed One, having taken to heart the supplication made by all the Tathāgatas, declared these words to the bodhisattvas: "Mind is the form of the body, and the body too is the form of mind, and mind itself is what is expressed through speech."

Then those bodhisattvas, having obtained the union of the body, speech, and mind of all the Tathāgatas, uttered this solemn declaration:

Ah, how wondrous is this Samantabhadra,
this vajra of body, speech, and mind —
phenomena are without arising,
without stirring and without abiding,
free from the stain of conceptuality.
It has been proclaimed: let it be cultivated.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Akṣobhya (the Unshakeable), entered meditative absorption into the samādhi called "the Vajra of the Unhindered Speech of the Tathāgata," and proclaimed this awakening mind:

These things have not arisen;
there is no bearer of characteristics and no nature of reality.
Like the sky, without object of focus —
the awakening mind is steadfast.

This was proclaimed by the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Vajra-Akṣobhya.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Ratnasambhava (Source of Jewels), entered meditative absorption into the samādhi called "All Tathāgatas Are Without Object of Focus," and proclaimed this awakening mind:

These things are without substance —
they have abandoned the defining mark of phenomena.
Excellent arisen from the selflessness of dharmas —
the awakening mind is steadfast.

This was proclaimed by the Blessed One Ratnaketu (Jewel-Crest).

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Amitābha, entered meditative absorption into the samādhi called "Blazing Vajra Flame," and proclaimed this awakening mind:

Things have no arising,
for things have no essential existence.
Thus the level of space is attained —
this is what is declared of things.

This was proclaimed by the Blessed One Amitābha.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Amoghasiddhi (Unfailing Accomplishment), entered meditative absorption into the samādhi called "Vajra of the Guru above All Gurus of All Tathāgatas," and proclaimed this awakening mind:

Phenomena are luminous by their intrinsic nature,
primordially pure, without turbidity.
There is no sentient being, and there is no life-force,
no buddhahood and no awakening.
Appearing like dream and illusion —
the awakening mind is steadfast.

This was proclaimed by the Blessed One Amoghasiddhi.

Then, moreover, the great bodhisattvas led by the bodhisattva Maitreya (Loving-Kindness), having obtained the vajra of body, speech, and mind of all the Tathāgatas — the pure awakening mind of the Tathāgatas — were filled with wonder and uttered this solemn declaration:

Ah, how wondrous, the buddhas — ah, how pure!
Ah, how wondrous, the Dharmas that have been taught!
Excellent arisen from the selflessness of dharmas —
O awakening mind, we bow to you.

Arising from the immovable syllable
of the cultivation of the awakening mind,
unborn like a dream and all the rest —
O awakening mind, we bow to you.

Having contemplated the place and the seat,
taking the cross-legged posture of the hero,
abiding first in the manner of the pure Dharma,
understanding that intrinsic nature is pure —

Let the mind form the syllable Hūṃ, making it a vajra.
Let Vajrasattva bestow blessing.
Cultivate pride in the jewel-body.
With hands raised in praise and circling,

Let the hook also draw in the wisdom being.
Upon arrival, bind in the straight direction,
and the supreme samaya offering, too, shall be presented.

Having offered the seats one by one,
perform the preparatory acts of presenting the water offering.
Enact the essential forms of the empowerment — weapons, armor,
and the offering of cymbals and the like.

The one who is to be pleased in every aspect,
the master who embodies yoga —
know that yoga is of three kinds:
the yoga of blessing, the yoga of thorough examination,
and the yoga of bringing form to full completion —
so declared the buddhas.

Through the mantra's blessing, arouse pride.
That yoga is declared to be blessing.

The awakening mind (bodhicitta) is pure,
and the seed of the secret mantra is supremely born.
Through progressive examination gathered in the assembly of mudrās,
the form is to be brought to completion step by step.
That, expressed through examination,
is declared to be the yoga of ritual procedure.

From the practice of gathering and expanding,
endowed with all supreme aspects
and perfected in a single moment's primordial wisdom —
this is called the yoga of completion.

At the outset, examine the sacred commitment with the awareness of yoga,
blessed as samaya.
The bringing to full perfection —
this is taught as the yoga of ritual.

The mind laden with the stains of affliction
is to be purified by the awakening mind.
Saying "This is pure by its very nature,"
join the palms three times.

Once purified, then with the mind
individually examine the mind itself.
Having individually examined the mind,
make the outer world empty by its intrinsic nature.

Resting in mind-only,
through the imprints of the accumulation toward awakening,
contemplate the essence of what is to be meditated upon —
visualize it in the form of the moon disc.

Dwelling upon the pure lotus,
formed from the sprout of the syllable OM,
a body possessing all the defining characteristics of every limb —
meditate upon the vajra body.

ĀḤ — the speech free from conceptual elaboration.
The mind is emanated as HŪṂ.
By these three syllables the body is blessed.

The moon-disc form dwelling at the heart —
upon it, one's own syllable,
its hue and form radiating light —
having aroused pride, proclaim oneself the very essence of vajra.

Complete with every ornament,
adorned with a maṇḍala of light,
with a network of limbs interlaced —
contemplate the fully complete wisdom being.

Below that, with the hand mudrā,
perform the armor, the weapons, and so forth.
The five perfect buddhas bestow empowerment,
and the crown is covered with garlands.

Then, below that, the buddhas'
emanation performance flows as magical display.
The fourth limb, armored and powerful —
the ten wrathful ones in the ten directions,
the bearer of the knife,
the one bearing a crest,
the lady with weapons,
and the one who delights in play —
these are the aspects of the magical display.

Bless the supernatural transformation.
Placing variety in the center of that which pervades all,
through the five great suchness selves,
let it pervade the four quarters and the surrounding assembly.
Also emanate the four joy-producing joys.

The mantra practitioner of the joy appropriate to all samādhis —
the forms of wheel and vajra,
the forms of lotus —
these all sport as lotus in their essence through all the wheels,
and from the emission of the syllable E,
fashion a form with a hue of one's identity.

Behold oneself seated on one's own throne,
adorned with all beautiful ornaments.

Perform the offering in its varied forms —
grace, song, and dance,
victory banners and the like, colored pennants,
and the form of cymbal offerings.

Having visualized one's body endowed with all aspects,
offer what is to be done swiftly;
abandon diminishment of unclear visualization,
and abandon all base thoughts.

Then recite the secret mantra.
If one grows weary of recitation, with the right hand
tighten the grip, then rub the vajra;
with the left hand ring the bell;
and through various vajra song-melodies
and offerings performed in the manner of banners, make offering.

Having entered through recitation and accustomed oneself,
make the request for the deity to depart, and accomplish oneself.
Meditate on body, speech, and mind.

Go with firmness wherever one wishes to go. Should obstacles arise,
consecrate with the hundred-syllable mantra. Through such meditation, the
one who meditates swiftly attains the awakening perfectly complete in the
Vajra Vehicle, and appears like the maṇḍala of sun and moon. Drawing forth
the summit of diverse activities, one greatly delights in the precious victory
banner. One who carries the lineage of the lotus of the Victors becomes the
great lord of the world, the Īśvara of sacred sites. Glorious sovereign of all
knowledge-mantras, one becomes a great-bliss hook for all desired things.
Knowing all things as though illusion, one blazes with wrath to subdue the
arrogant.

This was the sixth chapter of the Glorious Vajra-Heart Ornament Tantra, the
chapter on accomplishing the wisdom of meditating on the awakening mind.

Fire abiding in that very truth of the burnt offering is the mouth of the gods.
The burnt offering — which accomplishes diverse activities — is here fully
explained. Through burnt offerings the gods are satisfied, and being satisfied
they bestow attainments. Whatever excess or insufficiency there is in the
secret mantras is all replenished through burnt offerings. Therefore the Three
Bodies, through the supreme Dharma, have greatly praised the burnt offering.

Fire born from the fire-drill performs virtuous activities. Fire born from an outcaste's hearth or from a charnel ground fully accomplishes the fierce activities.

The fire-pit, whether round, four-sided, crescent-shaped, triangular, or fitted with a maṇḍala rim, is adorned with vajra symbols.

The one who knows the proper rite of burnt offering places in the center of the fire-pit, upon a lotus, an uṣṇīṣa, a vajra, a jewel, and a lotus.

Having fumigated as visualized and held the ladle between the two hands at knee height, fill the ladle for pouring with butter, and pour it likewise into the fire. Place the offering implements for the burnt offering to the right, and arrange a vessel of water to the left. The one who performs all activities should recite, then make the smoke offering, scatter-offering, and libation. Encircle the rim of the fire-pit with sharp tips of kuśa grass. Knowing the fire to blaze, and practising the fearlessness of the right side, invite the fire deity in accordance with the rite by means of this secret mantra:

Om agnaye ādibya āvīṣe āvīṣe mahāśriye hābyakābya vāhanāya svāhā.

With the left hand offer the vajra smoke-offering; present the fivefold offerings of water-offering and worship. From the direction of the fire there approaches one with a great belly and three eyes, with four faces and four arms, red in color, with a topknot of matted hair, dwelling in the maṇḍala of fire, adorned with rays of action-light. The first right hand grants supreme boons; in the second is a rosary of mantra-jewels. The left hand pours a ball of water over the crown of the head; in the second is a lance. Red in color, without ornaments, he is entirely surrounded by sages. Having visualized this form, invite him to be present in the center of the hearth.

For the burnt offering, present the oblation three times to each. Then, having performed the scatter-offering and libation, transform into the blazing form. Following this sequence, let the skilled one satisfy the gods. Having well satisfied them, offer apology, and then request the desired attainments.

Let the skilled one examine the signs of the vase, the victory banner, the vajra, the parasol, the form of the lotus hook, the white color of the flame, its light, and its curling — by these signs one knows what will swiftly come to pass, and should apply effort in meditation and recitation.

For the activities of pacification, enrichment, and subjugation: at the end, with Om at the beginning and Svāhā at the close, extend the melodic line of the

vowel sounds and join them with an unobstructed melody. For pacification, with a peaceful mind, bring forth enrichment through prosperity. With posture proper to the condition of delight and ease, perform subjugation through one who has been brought under power. Abiding in the conduct and manner of the fierce —

— with Hūṃ and joined with Phaṭ, the body blazing with tongues of fire, and the three worlds conceived of as food to be devoured — apply the seed-syllables of the secret mantra that belong to summoning and spreading activity.

One who knows the ritual of mantra accomplishment should, in all fire-offering rituals, offer and worship what is genuine and possessed of the various actions. For that very fire offering, first fill, pour in, and burn the offering substances, then present them; afterward, sequentially elaborate each in turn. For pacification, enrichment, and subjugation, perform the fire offering with virtuous substances.

Excrement, urine, blood, bones, and great flesh may also be used as fire offerings. But if one were to fill the face of a wisdom bodhisattva with impure things, how could that be? How would wrongdoing not arise from that? And if wrongdoing were to arise, what would its fruit be?

Sentient beings are confused through not knowing. Having cast aside skillful means and wisdom, and being attached to external things, those who have been cast into the net of conceptual thought — these beings discern phenomena through a twofold analysis into the two heaps of virtue and non-virtue. Yet these phenomena are pure in their intrinsic nature: they are without arising and without abiding. For the purpose of extending the understanding of sentient beings, the buddhas have taught this as a method.

For the sake of the ultimate, having abandoned virtue, what need is there even to speak of non-merit? Consider, for example, a person who, wishing to go to the far shore of a river, gathers grass and wood and the like, fashions a raft, boards it, crosses well, then abandons it and goes on happily. In just the same way, having fashioned the Dharma path that leads to the far shore of saṃsāra, one abandons both Dharma and what is not Dharma, and attains the happiness of awakening.

Therefore, having abandoned conceptual thought, extend the profound Dharma. Do not apply conceptual thinking to the vidyāmantra teachings spoken by the Tathāgata. Conceptual thought is a great bewilderment that

causes one to fall into the ocean of saṃsāra. Therefore rest in a non-conceptual meditative absorption that is stainless, like the sky.

With the two faculties joined in union, body, speech, and mind gathered in, a body resplendent through the pride of the sovereign self, adorned with all aspects — one who possesses this yoga will in this very life come to perfect gnosis.

The many male and female forms that are taught as arising from actions: one should not delight in those. This is the vajra-body samaya. With a mind caught in the net of bad thoughts and good thoughts, do not let sentient beings be oppressed by manifold torment. This is the vajra-body samaya. Do not speak words generated by craving — coarse, rough, or deceitful — but speak what gives ease when heard. This is the vajra-speech samaya.

The great tumult, Vairocana supreme, abides in the element of flesh. In the feet, the unstirring one is expansive; in the blood, the jewel's arising is primary. In the bone-joints of the skeleton of sentient beings, Amitābha. In the assemblies of channels with their interconnections, the supreme-born Sage, the Meaningful One. This, taught by the great secret holder to those for whom the samaya is auspicious — let the wise vajra-holders always rely upon it and meditate.

The five phenomena here set forth — which purify attachment, delusion and bewilderment, craving and conditioning factors — have been proclaimed by the supreme-born Sages.

Excrement, urine, semen, saliva, blood, and generative fluid, subsumed under the four elements — by means of a meditative understanding that comprehends them, one should make the samaya firm. Eat and offer them always.

This is the seventh chapter, the chapter on fire offerings, from the Tantra of the Glorious Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra (Śrī Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāratantra).

Now, there is something further to be explained. From the arising of the wisdom-sun that dispels the darkness of ignorance for beings, the method for clearing away the darkness of obstacles is taught. The assembly of Yamāntaka and the rest — their colors, hand implements, and so forth — all of these were previously set forth in detail, individually and extensively. Those are the wrathful ones governed by the specifics of action.

What has not been explained elsewhere shall now be explained here.

From the wisdom of the syllable HRŪṂ there arises the Uṣṇīṣa Tejas Skandha — the radiant mass of the uṣṇīṣa. With three faces of lustrous yellow, six hands holding the sun and so forth, he sits in the cross-legged posture, adorned with a crown of matted locks. Rays of his form fill the entire sky, shaking every world-realm. Held in close embrace by his wisdom-consort, he exerts himself with the delight of passionate union. For one who meditates in this way, harm from obstructing spirits will never come. This is the meditative absorption called Vajra Without Fault.

Again, from the wisdom of HRŪṂ arises one who bears the mantra-wheel. With three faces gleaming like gold, six hands holding the wheel and so forth, adorned with a crown of matted locks, wearing a tiger-skin garment and ornamented on his body with a garland of skulls, he dwells together with his wisdom-consort, full of passionate longing, engaging in the union of playful and elegant expression. For one who takes delight in meditating on this, Vajrasattva himself, together with his retinue, comes to that very place by day and by night and provides constant protection. Because one acts in accordance with his command, this is the meditative absorption called Vajra of Obedience.

Likewise, from the wisdom of HRŪṂ arises the wrathful one, Uṣṇīṣarāja — the King of the Uṣṇīṣa. With three faces of lustrous yellow, six hands holding the iron hook and so forth, perfectly adorned with serpents, he presses the lord of obstacles beneath his feet and strikes with a great roar of laughter, his crown adorned with matted locks. For the yogi who meditates on such a wrathful one — if even the obstructing spirits emanated by a buddha are destroyed, what need is there to speak of all the others? This is the meditative absorption called Vajra that Hooks the Heart.

From HRŪṂ again arises Uṣṇīṣa Samaya Caryāvān — the one adorned with the uṣṇīṣa who acts according to the samaya. With three faces radiant as molten gold, six hands holding the skull-cup and so forth, blazing magnificently in many colors, adorned with a crown of matted locks, his feet moving and striding forth, possessed of the discernment of emanation and withdrawal — for whoever meditates in this way, the obstructing spirits such as Vināyaka find no opportunity. One should therefore meditate on this precisely as it is. This is the meditative absorption called Vajra Invincible to Others.

From the syllable HRŪṂ there also arises Nāma Uṣṇīṣa Vikīrṇa — the one whose uṣṇīṣa disperses names. With three faces like refined gold, six hands

holding the trident and so forth, he dwells above the realm where life-breath has departed. By the power of his sport he binds the mouths of obstructing spirits. Adorned with a crown of matted locks, he emanates clouds of buddhas with delight. The yogi who meditates in this way dons the armor and, by his nature of solidity, no obstructing body can move against him. This is the meditative absorption called Vajra Victorious over Obstacles.

From the power of the wisdom of HRŪṢ arises the supreme Uṣṇīṣa Vijaya — the pre-eminent destroyer. With three faces whose light equals that of gold and sun combined, six hands holding the vajra and so forth, he presses obstacles down with a needle, and is embraced by his passionate wisdom-consort, adorned with a crown of matted locks, his blood-tinged tongue rolling out. For one who desires to attain unsurpassed awakening and meditates in this way, the harm of obstructing spirits will not come even across the span of eighty aeons. This is the meditative absorption called Wisdom Vajra that Empties Obstacles.

Again, from the wisdom of HRŪṢ there truly arises the auspicious white one. With three faces abiding like molten gold, six hands holding the parasol and so forth, he acts as refuge for those who are destitute and without protection, gives children to barren women and to childless mothers, adorned with a crown of matted locks — this great form who is endowed with a wisdom-consort —

The yogin who meditates upon this and recites with one-pointed concentration will not be afflicted by the harm of obstructing spirits. This is the meditative absorption called the Jewel Refuge Vajra.

When a yogin of exceptional distinction meditates supremely upon these wheels as the principal means of guarding awakening, the inner obstructing spirits will be unable to approach. One who seeks the essence of awakening, meditating upon such a wheel-endowed form with vigor and sustained yogic meditation, will before long attain what is desired.

This has been the eighth chapter of the Glorious Vajra Essence Ornament Tantra, the chapter on the arising of the crown protrusion of the essence of awakening.

Then all the vajra ḍākinīs assembled and, having paid homage to the Vajra-Holder (Skt. Vajradhara), the lord of all Tathāgatas, addressed him with these words: What is the glory of this? What is the meaning of vajra, essence, and likewise ornament? Oh sublime one, please, we beseech you, reveal this.

Then the Vajra-Holder, lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to them: This is concealed deeply in the uncommon secret tantra. Listen with one-pointed attention as I teach correctly and as it truly abides.

By the supreme bliss of body, speech, and mind, one is to be aroused from the goddess. Through the bliss of great awakening, the mantra practitioner acts in proper accordance. Uttering the essence of the stirring and speaking JA, instant by instant, one abides in one's own place. That very reality, the very divine, is to be generated.

Endowed with the sixteen portions, within the secret bindu of the moon — just like a flower — it is to be stirred by the offering of wind. Stirring it thus, accomplishment is achieved. In the same way, what is to be stirred: the luminous-like garland of the channels — from the two roots above and in front, correctly abiding in the sixteen abodes — from there enters into the center of the heart. Propelled by the offering of the yoga of wind, the perfect body, radiant and complete, glorious above, is to be recognized as one's own glory.

The great siddhi arising from that — dwelling in the jewel, free from conceptual thought — the body that is gathered as the letter-free bindu is to be recognized as the co-emergent. The form body of that very one — filling the entire expanse of space — acting through a knowing that is free and pure: this is to be recognized as the glory of others.

These arise from causes — the gnosis and wisdom supremely secret, perfecting the secret — and are called the Vajra Essence Ornament. Arising from the goddess, endowed with bliss, the pure continuum shining like a rainbow: that indestructible luminous body, I, Vajra, have truly proclaimed.

All the phenomena of appearance and existence, gathered together as the sublime stacked body, resting absorbed in the conceptual-thought-free continuum — because it arises, it is proclaimed the Essence. Because it beautifies both the pure and the impure throughout the extent of saṃsāric appearance — because it adorns both — it is truly proclaimed the Ornament.

Because the four — glorious, vajra, essence, and ornament — are interconnected and bring accomplishment, it is taught under the name Tantra. The meaning of the title, comprising as many dharmas as the eighty-four thousand categories, I have correctly explained as gathered into this meaning. The meaning was not proclaimed elsewhere. It has been concealed in other tantras for the student who does not understand, out of respect for the

teacher.

If one does not rightly know this meaning, however many meanings one imagines — countless — even knowing them, there is no fruit from that. Wishing for this, satisfy him and receive it perfectly.

This has been the ninth chapter of the Glorious Vajra Essence Ornament Tantra, the chapter on the arising of the names of the three wisdoms.

Those who propound the doctrine of permanent non-obstruction —

One who strives to revile the guru
must, for the sake of the sacred commitment (samaya), be utterly destroyed.
Their flesh, blood, and brains
shall be drawn out and made into a Dharma feast.
If this is not done, that deluded one
will acquire an accumulation of suffering:
all diseases and great rage,
terror and nearby harm —
throughout countless tens of millions of aeons
they will be thoroughly filled with great suffering,
wailing and crying, adorned with serpents,
proceeding forever through immeasurable torment.
Therefore seal this action firmly.

Having oneself become the form of the wrathful vajra ḍākinī,
with three faces like blue utpala flowers
and six arms, holding vajra, trident, phurba,
skull, curved knife, and wheel —
hideous and wrathful, with five tongues —
having visualized this, direct the intention into the sky below,
and with the object of the rite fully in view,
assign to that one abiding in the maṇḍala of sentient beings
the fault they have committed, through Vajrakīla (phurba) and so forth.

Then with the ritual implements — trident and fierce, supreme phurba —
thoroughly pierce the five points:
the head, the heart, the navel,
the two feet, and the hands.

With the five rays of light of the five heavy ones,
draw out all the blood with mantra as a worm draws out moisture,
pour it into a skull cup, and drink.

Likewise gather the flesh and examine it as food.
Boil the bones as well
and unite the consciousness with the vajra-lotus.

Through this, which is supremely effective in accomplishing the aim,
within half a month
even a great vajra-holder
will undoubtedly die.

Having perfectly accomplished this vajra secret practice,
evil karma will not bring that one to ruin —
they will be born as a buddha.
That yogin too, by its power,
will become the wrathful vajra ḍākinī.
Killing and reviving the three realms,
stabilizing the mind's vajra,
they will accomplish this in a mere instant —
that is certain and clear beyond doubt.

This has been the tenth chapter of the Glorious Vajra Essence Ornament
Tantra, the chapter on slaying an enemy through the practice of the wrathful
vajra ḍākinī.

Then further, what is to be explained:
the tantra of the great method of desire —
whoever knows it well
is said to be granted accomplishment (siddhi) in this very life.

The Guhyasamāja (Secret Assembly), one thousand sections;
the Vajramālā, three hundred thousand;
the Intention-Prophecy, four thousand sections;
the Four Goddesses' Inquiry, seventy;
the Uttaratantra, two hundred and eight;
its explanatory tantra;
the Great Samaya, fifty-five;
the Five-Vajra Assembly, one thousand sections;
the Compendium of All, one hundred thousand;
Equality of Victory, two hundred and ten;
Secret Moon Bindu, seven thousand sections;
Vajra Underground, one hundred and twenty;

Diadem Vajra, seven hundred and five;
Wrathful Moon Bindu, five hundred thousand;
Vajra Victory, nine hundred and ninety;
Secret Equality, five thousand sections;
Vajra Secret Ornament, five thousand sections;
Vajra Secret Beauty, seven thousand sections;
Jewel Secret Bindu, ten hundred thousand;
Illuminating Display of Magic, one thousand one hundred;
Vajra Secret Ornament, one thousand sections;
Vajra Skull, two hundred and one hundred;
That Very Reality, one hundred thousand, one hundred thousand and seven;
Samaya Manifest Ornament, three thousand sections;
Mañjuśrī the Hero, one hundred thousand;
Great Secret Assembly, one hundred and fifty;
Jewel Tree, nine hundred and seven;
Time Bindu, one hundred and eighty;
Goddess-Proclaimed Dharma, five hundred and seven.

All of these I shall teach correctly according to their distinctions of intent. This is the teaching of the divisions of tantra through pairs embracing one another. Likewise, by grasping the limbs and understanding through their scope and manner of presentation, all the tantras should be understood. Likewise, through aversion and delusion, all the tantras should be known. All the tantras of the *ḍākinīs* should also be known in this sequence. By knowing the distinction between outer and inner, the divisions of tantra should be understood. Receive it correctly from the guru who teaches inwardly, and accomplish it.

With insight into things as they abide,
the Sugata has taught all the tantras.
This tantra, the Ornament of the Vajra Essence,
is the father of the *ḍākinī* tantras
and the final word of all the tantras.
Whatever meaning has not been proclaimed elsewhere
is here taught completely.
Whatever yogin receives it, or meditates upon it,
or expounds it, or reads it —
that great yogin

shall become like me itself.

This was the eleventh chapter of the glorious Vajra Essence Ornament Tantra, the chapter on the divisions of all the tantras.

Then, moreover, what further is to be explained:

Through the various sūtras and tantras,
when one comes to know the vows correctly,
it is said one becomes a great ḍākinī.

The particular account of the vows extracted from the hearers (śrāvakas),
and the distinctions of transgressions and abandonments,
are here perfected as well through the trainings and the [associated]
substances.

Through moral discipline the three trainings are fulfilled:
gathering virtuous phenomena,
the twenty or more vows,
and the discipline of acting for the benefit of sentient beings —
the discipline of a bodhisattva, supremely bestowed.
By the vow of going forth in body, speech, and mind,
one connects correctly with the ḍākinī tantras.

Observing the lunar fasting days, keeping pure conduct,
whether in town, in the dark wilderness, or on the plain,
one does not bring harm through body, speech, or mind.

The supreme vow of the Tathāgata,
the unsurpassable awakening mind,
the awakening mind that acts for the benefit of beings —
let the awakening mind be firmly taken up.

Of the great family of the vajra, the immovable one,
by taking up the great vajra, the bell,
and likewise the master,
one attains the qualities thereof.

Of the lofty family of the jewel pinnacle,
by giving gifts of material things, of fearlessness, of Dharma, and of
loving-kindness
three times by day and three times by night,
one attains the qualities thereof.

Of the families of the lotus, the luminous one,
by firmly upholding the outer, inner, and secret pledges (samāyas),
one attains unsurpassable awakening.

Of the many families of the karma, the drum-sound,
endowed with pledges and vows,
by performing service, honor, and offerings, and acting for the benefit of
sentient beings,
one attains the qualities thereof.

Do not take life, do not engage in sexual misconduct,
do not take what is not given, do not speak falsely.
Divisive speech, frivolous speech, harsh speech —
do not speak them. Covetousness,
malice, and wrong views —
these are never to be done.

Do not abandon the Three Jewels.
Likewise with the gods and the guru.

Since it is the root of all faults,
alcohol too is to be thoroughly abandoned.

A mudrā, a vehicle, weapons and the like,
the shadow of a sign or of a deity —
do not step over them or eat together with them.

And so on — the limitless vows
that are thus taught:
these lead one who is a beginner on this path
to enter correctly.

The fourteen uncommon root downfalls (pārājikas)
as they are known —
since through them a mantra practitioner accomplishes all aims,
they are not to be abandoned or discarded.

Reviling the master from the heart,
transgressing the words of the Sugata,
holding a Dharma-sibling in contempt through aversion,
abandoning sentient beings without loving-kindness,
discarding the great awakening mind,
disparaging the view of the established reality of self and other,
teaching secrets to an unsuitable vessel,

reviling the aggregates as the very nature of the Victors,
harboring doubt about the pure Dharma,
being loving toward the wrathful while possessing those three faults,
applying conceptuality to emptiness pushed to an extreme,
undermining the faithful mind,
not observing the pledges while making pretense of doing so,
reviling wise women —
these the mantra practitioner must thoroughly abandon,
and will then definitively attain siddhi.
But a mantra practitioner who has strayed from these
will certainly encounter māra,
sickness and suffering will increase,
and without support one will fall headlong into the hell of the heaped-up.
Even the fault of a gross downfall
should be understood as analogous to these.

Not holding the pledges, yet relying on a wisdom consort,
engaging in dispute within the feast-wheel assembly,
teaching the secret Dharma to others,
teaching it elsewhere to those who have faith —

Dwelling long among hearers within,
revealing secrets to an unsuitable vessel —
these become a gross transgression,
and the mantra practitioner's pledges and vows are exhausted.
When they are exhausted, siddhi will not come.
Therefore, every single day, three times,
one should recite and read these aloud.

Regarding the beholding of a maṇḍala, entering it,
receiving empowerment, and other such proper procedures —
the vajra-dākinī attainment differs from others.
The bodhicitta [vow], the hearer [vow],
both the conduct and the yoga tantra —
those intended meanings do not apply in the same way here.
Therefore, I will now teach perfectly
the supreme of all vows.

The great fragrance, fragrant water, and blood (rakta),
together with wisdom fluid and bodhicitta substances —
these are to be consumed properly with the feast-union.
Because the wisdom of the belly is refined through a human being,
it becomes superior to outer food.

Likewise, elephant, horse meat,
beef, dog meat, and great flesh —
because they are in their essential nature the five wisdoms,
one should eat them with a mind of joy.

Likewise, one should slay sentient beings.
One should also take what has not been given.
One should engage in desire with all women.
One should also speak false words.
By doing so, buddhas
and bodhisattvas will be pleased,
and sentient beings too will be satisfied and joyful.

Likewise, by means of the yoga essence,
toward buddhas and bodhicitta,
one's own guide, hearers, physical images, and so forth —
by applying the three pure unifications with oneself,
making prostrations would be improper.
Always, from the maṇḍala of Vajrasattva's
body, speech, and mind,
by applying the three samādhis with oneself,
one should not make distinctions with the intellect.

Maṇḍalas are not to be drawn.
Texts are not to be read.
One should not depart from the stūpa.
Hand mudrās are to be abandoned.

Each day, at the four times of day,
through skillful intimacy with a well-trained girl,
taking camphor and sandalwood as pledged —
according to the rite, one makes offering with the body's retinue.

The manifold means of enjoyment
are thoroughly taught in my tantra.
From the rest-point of the sixteen bindu drops (bindus),

one should investigate the essence of the mantra.

The holy guru, with great compassion,
directed toward the teachings given perfectly —
casting aside entirely the burden of perversion,
one will become like me, a holder of the vajra.

This is the twelfth chapter, the chapter on distinguishing pledges and vows,
from the Tantra of the Ornament of the Vajra Heart, the Glorious Vajra.

Then the true accomplishment of the great zombie
shall be explained.

If the practitioner knows this well,
siddhi will be attained.

On the eighth or the fourteenth day
of the dark fortnight, either will do —
at a charnel ground with a single tree, or at a mother-spirit,
or in a deserted village —
one who has beforehand the nature of a practitioner
accomplishes all activities through the practice.

An arrow-woman and a woman with a mole,
a caṇḍāla woman and a dancing woman and the like,
one who has a gap between her front teeth,
possessed of radiance and complexion, without wounds —
praised at thirty-two years of age,
or else twenty-five,
or one born at the first of the waters (a water birth),
who has been trained and not yet corrupted by death —
taking her up properly and placing her on a flat stone.

Also, seizing the girl by the hair —
with the laughter of a god, the hand of the lord (Indra),
white powder, the sound of mountains,
and pressing strokes, wash her with water.

Then with white sandalwood
anoint the girl's body; with ornaments and clothes
adorn her properly and place her in front.
Draw the dreadful maṇḍala.

Recite thoroughly the root and other secret mantras.
Give also the torma (ritual cake) of the spirits.

In black flesh, possessed of luster,
with an intoxicating substance burned in the corpse's mouth —
on a single night, perform the offering-fire with the right cord of contact.

Then also at the time of the morning bell,
having scattered great blood in the four directions,
anoint the corpse with great butter oil.

Then that corpse will rise up,
and an ācārya endowed with wrath
will fill the three earth-worlds with his roar.

At that moment, the practitioner must not be afraid.

With the application of Māmakī and the like,
one should protect oneself with the protective wheel.

If one is afraid, one should immediately slay it.

At that time, having been guarded by the protection,
one rises up oneself, and at its head —

one should strike it with white mustard seed. Then it will fall down, and standing before the practitioner it will speak these commanding words: "Great sentient being, what do you desire? Command me truly. A sword, eye-medicine, the underworld, or swift feet — likewise take the essence. From among the rites of summoning the invisible, I will join whichever one you choose." Then the practitioner, having stated whatever he wishes, should beat the small drum. Then from the mouth of that risen corpse smoke billows forth and fire blazes. Then, like a black serpent, it will emerge from the mouth of the corpse. The practitioner should take it up with his mouth, and it will arise and become a golden sword. Holding that, one will certainly travel upward to the world-realm of Brahmā, and likewise travel everywhere. Likewise, whatever substance it is shown to, all will become like gold-transforming elixir. If one performs the method of accomplishment in this way, the corpse will become as required previously, and having performed the great offering-fire with it, one should fully satisfy the maṇḍala. Therefore this is the supreme means of accomplishment, the one that truly brings all aims to fruition and is the chief of all activities — thus spoke the Blessed One Vajrasattva (Skt. vajrasattva). This is the thirteenth chapter, the Chapter on the Great Risen Corpse, from the tantra called the Glorious Vajra-Heart Ornament.

Now, since the accomplishments of the practitioner arise from the ācārya, I shall explain the ritual of honoring the ācārya as taught in all the tantras. Without an ācārya, accomplishment will not be attained; therefore, with single-pointed mind, listen carefully to the number and defining characteristics of the ācārya. The one who is a pure vessel of sacred vows, who perfects all the defining characteristics of an ācārya, and who first engages one in activity — that is the causal ācārya. The one who holds the hare, who rouses and purifies the field of one's practice, and who makes one a fit vessel for the illusory gnosis — that is the great conditional ācārya. One who has listened alongside another will thereby attain genuine joy, and having attained it, will fully arrive at the ultimate. The co-operative ācārya is unwavering, possessed of loving-kindness and wisdom, skilled in the joining of mantra and tantra, expert in the maṇḍala, knowing the ten suchnesses, joyful in the Great Vehicle, and able to hold secrets — such a one is the ācārya. Having fine eyes and sixteen teeth, having abandoned confused thinking, devoted to the lama and filled with faith, richly adorned with ornaments, faithful and habituated to the practices, of beautiful form and intoxicating with desire, exceedingly tame and distinctive, accepted as a proper object of honor — such a one is delighted in virtue and meditation.

A disciple who is always reverential toward the lama should regard the lama in this way: the lama is equal to all buddhas; he is always in truth Vajradhara (Skt. vajradhara); he is the Tathāgata, the source of jewels; he is the great ocean of gnosis; he bestows the wish-fulfilling jewel. One should hold fast to all his qualities and never entertain any fault of his even in one's mind. By holding to his qualities one attains accomplishment; through entertaining faults one causes accomplishment to decline. Because it is as grave a misdeed as destroying a stūpa, one should not even tread on his shadow — to say nothing of treading on his seat, his shoes, his mount, or whatever he would walk upon. Through him, all that is highest among moving and non-moving things will be relinquished. One who reviles the ācārya should not even be seen in a dream. Such a person is seized by demons and evil spirits, gripped by plague, pox, and the Lord of Death, and will come to die. Such a one is wicked, fierce, and greatly foolish. Even should he travel to the four directions, the wise should not protect him without restraint; rather, they should slay the transgressor with weapons such as spears. I hereby declare that one who reviles the ācārya will dwell in the hell described in the sūtras and other teachings. Therefore, at the feet of the lama, guard your modesty like a bride.

Yawning, laughing, and belching and the like — cover the mouth with the hand before doing so. Speak very gently. Binding one's hair and applying weapons-grease should not be done in the lama's presence. Stamping the feet and words of cruelty should not be done within earshot. Walking ahead of the lama and stretching out one's legs — these should truly not be done. When the lama is performing an action or is engaged in listening and such things, one should not stand with palms unjoined, nor, having risen from one's place and come within sight, turn one's back. However, at night, when crossing water, or when staying in a narrow passage or ravine, walking ahead is not a fault, since one does so in order to clear the way at the lama's command. Therefore, by all means, please the supreme vajra-holding lama through conformity and compliance. When he is pleased, all the buddhas are pleased. Whoever truly reviles the ācārya, even having excellently accomplished the supreme practice of all tantras, having abandoned sleep and distractions, for a thousand aeons — that one brings about the accomplishment of hell and the like. Therefore, all should exert themselves with great diligence. Those sentient beings endowed with faith who desire the fruit of buddhahood — which ripens the fruit of intention — should make offerings.

This is the fourteenth chapter, on honoring the lama, from the tantra called the Glorious Vajra-Heart Ornament.

From the Vajra-Lotus Union: because perfect wisdom (jñāna) arises from it, woman is the supreme illusion. Her names and characteristics are here taught. Hastinī, Śaṅkhinī, Kamalā, and Citrā — all four become of the four lineages. The Hastinī: her taste is blood and acid, she is stout, with very great desire, her lotus is wide, her mouth emits the smell of putrid flesh, she drinks white liquor, her extremities are thick and her head large. The Śaṅkhinī: her blood-taste is sour, her waist is slender, her nose fine, she is slightly wrathful, smoke issues from her mouth, her gait is slow and graceful, her white liquor resembles the fruit of the śrī tree. Kamalā: her blood-taste is sweet, the Śaṅkhinī's blood-taste is sour, she is of medium build, reddish, and her eyes gaze with unblinking desire, her white liquor resembles the āriṣa fruit. Citrā: her blood-taste is sweet, occasionally wrathful in temperament, her gaze is not one of passion, her complexion is dark, and her white liquor opens to either side. If one truly encounters these women, one will be given authentic accomplishments (siddhi) in this very life. Therefore, seek them out with effort, and having truly found them, by drinking the white liquor within the range of a cow's diet, the crystal element increases abundantly. By bestowing that

through skillful means, truly examine the intrinsic nature. The intrinsic nature is like the sky — the exhaustion of all things — deep and true joy entirely free from all conceptual thought. Beyond thought, beyond exhaustion, subtle, supreme, peaceful, utterly pure. It is called the deathless vajra-nectar. In its center, perfectly adorned by the eight petals and five essences: from the center of that, taking five parts, the second part is drawn to the ends of the eight; of the thirty-tenths, the five-part, the second of the fifth and sixth is poured into the bindus. Whatever person gazes upon that with the rays of his eyes — there is no doubt that wisdom dwelling just as it is within that will arise. Whenever the mind of cessation arises, he will come to hold the supreme of all buddhas and become like a glorious *ḍākinī*. From this day forward, you, my son, who truly inquire about the *maṇḍala* and who unite the tantra of practice — you shall become a great *ācārya*. This is highly praised by all the buddhas even when conferring empowerment; all mantras will be accomplished, and the supreme and special activities will also be achieved. This girl is suited to you. Fulfill your desire for sentient beings, my son. This delightful *vidyā* — all the Sugatas (the well-gone buddhas) declare her your domain of practice. If you unite your mind with emptiness, you will truly become supreme.

This is the delight of the Sugatas, the makers of bliss. You have gone forth from this.

This has been the fifteenth chapter, the inquiry into the characteristics of wisdom with its object of meditation, from the Tantra of the Glorious Vajra-essence Ornament.

Then again, what is to be explained: if the practitioner has no knowledge of the ritual of all things, the accomplishments (*siddhi*) will not arise. Therefore, the discipline of conduct is taught here. All the efforts of practice should be abandoned through knowing suchness. Remain with certainty in *Vajrasattva* — abandon that, and do nothing else.

By abiding in that pure suchness, do not perform practices either. Through the practice of abiding in selflessness, examine discerningly for as long as it takes. Abiding in the station of non-existence, and possessed of excellent skillful means, whatever arises from the tantra will arise without having been deliberately sought. By the power of the practice of meditation, whatever may be the characteristics of accomplishment — all of it, in a single instant, becomes one's own abiding.

Therefore, to actual monks, to old logicians, to one's own children, and to kings — do not explain this suchness truly.

Just as a butter-lamp placed inside a vase does not shine its light outward, yet if that very vase is shattered, the lamp beneath blazes forth brightly — so too, this very body as the vase, skillfully broken open by the master's word, reveals suchness itself, like the lamp. It is the practice that discloses the suchness of practice.

When one abides in that very practice, at the time when the teaching is impermanent, dwelling thus and having abandoned worldly ways, having engaged in all conduct — at that time the buddhas behold such a one. By resolving all doubts entirely, conduct yourself with awareness as a child would. When the yogin is without attachment, excellence and abundance will increase.

One who is laden with all sins and in whom the obscuration of delusion is thoroughly entrenched — through the practice of the yoga of the mad one, in six months meaningful accomplishment is achieved. One then beholds all buddhas oneself, and is filled to fullness with all desires. A body that is inexhaustible and indestructible, a clear and pure life, will arise. The supreme awakening unsurpassed is authentically attained without effort. All the delights and pleasures of desire will be accomplished without striving.

While walking, sitting, and resting — examine the supremely profound abiding. This yogin who is the guide of the path of luminous wisdom, who examines characteristics — through this practice of meditative dhyāna and application, the precious jewel of mind will be made firm. One who has entered upon the awakening of the buddhas will also bestow blessing. Having entered thus, for as long as the mind does not grow weary, meditate with effort and a fine mind of meditative equipoise.

After that, when one has unified into a single whole the conduct of whatever is delightful, the mark of even slightly opening the eye — vast awakening will be attained. While laughing, or speaking, or sitting, or while some are dancing at great length — for as long as weariness does not arise, cling to the mind of meditation. A mantra practitioner who is endowed with such a commitment and is free from conceptuality — by the certainty of time, having abandoned all, will attain unsurpassed awakening.

This has been the sixteenth chapter, engaging in all that is to be known, from the Tantra of the Glorious Vajra-essence Ornament.

Then all those ḍākinīs assembled together and praised the Blessed One, Vajradhara, with these verses:

You are the god arisen from the intrinsic nature of all buddhas — you are supreme, the great seal of all bodhisattvas. Great ḍākinī, I pay homage to you.

All delusion is luminous — you are the great buddha of the ḍākinīs. The phenomena of visible form are thoroughly pure. Sugata-ḍākinī, I pay homage to you.

All pride is luminous — you are the ḍākinī who fulfills wishes. The phenomena of bliss and so forth are thoroughly pure.

Jewel-ḍākinī, I pay homage to you.

All attachment is luminous —
great ḍākinī, unstained by any flaw,
grasping at signs is thoroughly pure.

Lotus-ḍākinī, I pay homage to you.

The phenomenon of jealousy is luminous —
ḍākinī of variegated activity,
all the phenomena of manifest formations are pure.
Variegated ḍākinī, I pay homage and praise you.

By praising you with these supreme marks,
the person who does so accumulates merit,
and with the great accumulation of wisdom fully perfected,
there is no doubt that they will become a buddha.

Then the Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, entered into meditative absorption in the samādhi called "Arousing the Indestructible Moon that is the Essence of all Tathāgatas" — entering it through the great identity of Samantabhadra's great bliss pervading the entire expanse of space. From the indestructible drop at his own heart, he sent forth an assembly of rays of light called "Supreme Delight." He caused these to expand at the center of the drop of the moon, which is the secret essence of all Tathāgatas, made them shine throughout the entire expanse of space, dwelling above and below, and made them radiantly clear to every mountain and every sentient being without exception or remainder. Having delighted them with the bliss of supreme delight, the light returned, and the Blessed One came to rest in ease at the center of the moon-drop of the supreme essence, the lord of the bliss of supreme delight.

Then the Blessed One was aroused by that essence — the supreme chain of rays of light of all Tathāgatas, turned supremely blissful — and while performing a dance, each of the Tathāgatas, focusing on their own respective samādhi, was gathered into a single unity as the secret great joy-bliss at the center of the moon-drop at the heart of the Blessed One, the glorious Samantabhadra. Each then arose in their own form as a woman and emerged from the heart of the Blessed One.

Then all those assembled ḍākinīs, filled with great joy, raised a cry of jubilation and burst into a great melodious song:

Oh! The vajra of Vajrasattva —
the vajra of supreme great delight.

Oh! The great variegated means, maker of bliss —
the variegated wisdom, great bliss.

Oh! The virtuous wisdom of Samantabhadra,
maker of great bliss.

For the sake of that bliss, please abide
in the lotus of the wisdom-consort.

Oh! The vidyā is profoundly deep —
this perfection of wisdom (Prajñāpāramitā)
dispels for all sentient beings
the dense darkness of ignorance.

Oh! Everything is supremely wondrous —
performing the dance like ḍākinīs,
Vairocana — touching, stroking,
and the supreme rapture.

Oh! Supreme delight —
the fortunate, those who enjoy fortune,
and through variegated fortune, great maker of bliss —
the variegated vajra, supremely beautiful.

Then the great Vajradhara, lord of all Tathāgatas, arose from his meditative absorption, surveyed the maṇḍala of the retinue, and spoke these words:

The vowels and the consonants,
and the two aspects of the moon that arose from them —
the mirror-like wisdom
becomes one: that is equanimity.

The seeds that have become the signs —
I have explained these as discerning wisdom.
The buddhas who arose from that
strive earnestly to accomplish the welfare of beings.

The perfect image is the dharmadhātu —
the lord of gods generates buddhas.
With the intermediate drop one generates,
and by conferring it one generates as one's own deity;
the act of conferring blessing
is common to all the tantras.
Secret, greatly secret, supremely secret;
yoga, great yoga,
and what is called subsequent yoga;
empty and supremely empty,
what is called greatly empty;
joy, intermediate joy,
and the joys that are free of joy —
these are the crown of all the tantras.

The rites of the two reversals,
secret and wisdom-gnosis —
the rite of the union-opening,
the torma and vajra recitation,
the rite of wrathful accomplishment,
the consecration and the maṇḍala accomplishment —
these are the ten realities of the secret.

The maṇḍala, meditative absorption, and mudrā,
the bodily postures and seated stances, recitation,
fire offering, worship, the subsidiary practices,
and the form of the withdrawal —
these are the ten outer realities.

One who does not know the realities, the true nature of things,
yet proclaims himself a speaker of secret mantra —
such a one, in the arrogance of apparent knowledge, expounds the rites of
secret mantra,
and by that transgression ruins his samaya in this life and the next.
Through that breach māra seizes him, and after death he goes to hell.

Rely steadfastly upon sentient beings.
To attain supreme awakening
one must not deceive sentient beings;
engage them in the activity of the Sugata.
Whoever does not strive in this practice,
though he may give in generosity his limbs, his hands, his eyes, and so forth,
and though he may have practiced austerities of every kind,
he will never taste the flavor of the nectar.

Let the yogin master just this single yoga,
then go into solitude and apply himself with full effort —
in this very life evil is purified, buddhahood is achieved.
By meditating deeply on the selflessness of phenomena,
omniscience is thoroughly assimilated.
With the elegance of skillful means and wisdom joined as two,
one worships the nature of the five secrets.
By understanding the meaning of the fortyfold teaching
that all things are without inherent existence,
and by conferring the vajra and lotus empowerment,
one brings joy by means of the nectar.
The Dharma that is to be kept secret
should be practiced in concealment and hiddenness.
From among the five qualities of desire,
let the yogin practice them with awareness,
and likewise through eating and drinking
bring all sentient beings under mastery.
In this there is no ritual bathing or purification; there is no obstacle to offering.
There is no maṇḍala or fire offering, no fixed times or auspicious days.
There is nothing to be done such as tormas and the like — this is the supreme
among the supreme, the first and foremost.

This is the true practice of Vajrasattva; apply yourself to it with diligence.

Then all those dākinīs, filled with great joy, addressed the Blessed One, the Great Vajradhara: "Excellent! Excellent, O Great Bliss-Maker! Excellent! Excellent, O Great Gnosis! Excellent! Excellent, O Great Bliss! Excellent! Excellent, O Great Variety! Excellent! Excellent, O Great Wisdom! Excellent! Excellent, O Great Delight!"

Then the Blessed One, the Great Vajradhara, his great compassion turned inward, resting his mind upon his own true mind, remained in silence without uttering a word.

The glorious tantra of great yoga called The Definitive Reality Ornament of the Vajra Essence is complete. It came forth from the glorious secret hermitage of Oḍḍiyāna.

Translated and edited by the Indian paṇḍita Kamalagupta and the great Tibetan translator, lord and master, Lha Yeshe Gyaltsen, and established in definitive form.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "tenth portion" or "fifth portion" renders the Tibetan "cha shas Inga pa'i tshul du" literally as "in the manner of the fifth part." This is a technical tantric idiom indicating a specific mode of embodied or maṇḍalic presence; the exact doctrinal referent may vary by commentary. It does not straightforwardly mean "one-fifth" in a numerical sense but likely refers to a fivefold or quintessential mode of manifestation.

The names of several ḍākinīs contain Sanskrit loanwords embedded in Tibetan form. "Hāranupūra" (Tibetan: hā ra nu pū ra) likely refers to ornamental garlands and anklet bells, common iconographic attributes. "Gīta" refers to melodic song.

The phrase "She Who Makes the Three Known and Is Without Substance" attempts to render "gsum rig par byed pa dngos med ma," where "gsum" likely refers to the three — body, speech, and mind, or the three realms — and "dngos med" means "without inherent existence" or "incorporeal." The exact referent of "three" here may depend on the specific commentarial tradition.

- The phrase "buddhas of the lower grounds" in the opening verse renders a Tibetan term that could also be read as "buddhas of the inferior vehicle" or "buddhas below." In the tantric context the reference is most likely to buddhas at lower levels of realization or within lower maṇḍala tiers, though the exact referent is contextually uncertain.

The phrase rendered "drawing near to them" for "□□□□□□□□□□□□□□" is slightly compressed; the verb could also suggest "did not rely upon" or "did not approach for support." The list of negations that follows is a deliberate series of paradoxical non-actions describing the Blessed One's non-dual equipoise; the repetitive cadence is intentional and is preserved.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation preserves that break accordingly.

- The passage is a dense ritual-liturgical text from the Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra tantra. The mantras are rendered in standard Sanskrit transliteration as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering; minor phonetic variations from classical Sanskrit are preserved rather than corrected, as is standard practice for tantric mantras. The assignation of the Sanskrit vowels to women, the retroflex syllables to those of neither sex, and the consonantal series to males follows a well-known Vajrayāna exegetical system in which the Sanskrit alphabet is mapped onto categories of beings and elements. The final verse is incomplete and continues into the next passage.

- The phrase rendered "at the quarter of falselessness" translates "□□□□□□□□", literally "devoid of

truth" or "the truthless quarter." In tantric maṇḍala geography this refers to a specific intermediate directional position; the term may be a name or directional epithet whose precise identification varies by commentarial tradition.

The phrase 受稱讚之詞 rendered as "praised with utterances of acclaim" could alternatively mean "consecrated" or "made fully renowned"; the ambiguity is between laudatory and consecratory action, and the ritual context supports either reading.

The final sentence breaks off mid-construction in the Tibetan, as the passage ends there; the translation follows the text accordingly.

- The passage about the lion throne and offering one's own mother, sister, and wife as gifts to the master reflects the deliberately transgressive symbolic register of inner tantric literature. These are understood in the commentarial tradition as coded (twilight language, Skt. *sandhyābhāṣā*) references to tantric practices involving inner channels, winds, and drops, not literal injunctions. This is standard Mahāyoga-class tantra rhetoric.

The phrase rendered "the fourth of all the deities" is intentionally enigmatic in context; it likely refers to the fourth empowerment deity or the fourth category in the empowerment sequence.

- The Sanskrit mantra strings are rendered phonetically as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration; their internal segmentation and correct Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain in places, but they are kept as liturgical formulae without emendation, as is standard for dhāraṇī passages.

The phrase rendered "six subtle particles of mind" translates *sems kyi rdul phran cha drug*, a technical tantric expression. "Six subtle particles" or "six subtle aspects of mind" is the most natural reading; the precise doctrinal referent belongs to the inner commentary tradition of this tantra.

The epithet "Aḥ" and "Hūṃ" function as seed syllables in the sādhana and are left untranslated, as is conventional.

- The phrase rendered "Yamāntaka" for ཡམ་འན་ཐ་ཀ་ is a standard Tibetan epithet meaning "slayer of Yama, the Lord of Death." The text treats him as a gate-guardian wrathful deity distinct from but related to Amoghasiddhi's family in this mandala context.

The term प्रामथ्या is rendered "pramathas," a class of minor spirits attendant on Śiva's hosts, here functioning as retinue of the gate-guardian wrathful deities. The term is genuinely uncertain; some contexts read it as a class of female spirits.

The line 白地 contemplating the ground of union — rendered "contemplate the ground of union as white" — is a tantric technical phrase whose precise referent depends on the specific ritual commentary; the translation follows the most natural reading.

• The mantra passages are transcribed in Sanskrit phonetics in the original Tibetan and are reproduced here as found. The phrase rendered "White Garment" refers to Pāṇḍaravāsīnī, consort of Amitābha, whose Tibetan name means "clad in white"; this is standard in five-buddha-family Vajrayāna iconography. "Ākāśagarbha" is the Sanskrit restoration of the name appearing in the text as "Essence of Space, the great self," consistent with the preceding passage's listing of bodhisattvas as sense-faculty counterparts. The phrase "buddha's breath" renders a somewhat unusual compound and may alternatively be understood as "the buddha's own nostril-sense"; the doctrinal point is that one's nose-consciousness is identified with the buddha's olfactory gnosis. The "sixteen aspects" of Vajrasattva is a recognized Vajrayāna enumeration. The list of four mudrā-related practices (hook, lasso, chain-link, victory banner) corresponds to the four activities of the four mudrās in this genre of tantra.

- The text moves between two Tathāgatas named with overlapping epithets: "Ratnasambhava"

appears in the samādhi heading while the verse attribution uses "Ratnaketu" (འཇམ་མཛོད་ཀྱི་མཛེས་པ་). These are treated as two distinct names as the Tibetan clearly distinguishes them; Ratnaketu is a separate epithet or a variant name used in attribution.

The final stanzas shift register from doctrinal proclamation into sādhanā instruction, describing visualization practice: seated posture, generation of the seed-syllable Hūṃ, blessing by Vajrasattva, pride in the deity body, the gesture of invitation, the hook-mudrā for drawing in the wisdom being, binding, and offering of the samaya substance. This is standard generation-stage procedure and is rendered accordingly.

The line rendered "bind in the straight direction" reflects 直向來縛, literally "having come, bind facing straight" — a direction to face the invited being directly before binding; the doctrinal sense is retained.

- The passage is a dense tantric ritual instruction, likely from a generation-stage *sādhana* text. The three yogas described — yoga of blessing, yoga of examination, and yoga of completion — reflect a standard threefold schema in tantric ritual manuals. The term rendered "yoga of completion" here is distinct from the technical *rdzogs rim* (completion stage proper); it refers to the perfection of visualization within the generation stage.

The phrase "the five great suchness selves" refers to the self-identification with the five buddha families, each associated with one of the five wisdoms and one of the five directions — a standard Vajrayāna visualization schema.

The sequence of syllables OM, ĀḤ, HŪM representing body, speech, and mind respectively is standard tantric doctrine; the translation follows this threefold assignment.

• The mantra transliteration follows the Tibetan phonetic rendering closely. The Sanskrit underlying it appears to be an invocation of Agni, the fire deity: "Om, to Agni, the primordial, come, come, O great Śrī, the carrier of oblations, svāhā." The exact reconstruction is uncertain in places owing to the Tibetan phonetic approximation.

The term rendered "uṣṇiṣa" for 𑖦𑖫𑖞𑖩𑖪𑖭𑖮𑖱𑖳𑖴𑖶𑖷𑖹𑖺𑖻𑖼𑖽𑖾𑗀𑖿𑗁𑗂𑗃𑗄𑗅𑗆𑗇𑗈𑗉𑗊𑗋𑗌𑗍𑗎𑗏𑗐𑗑𑗒𑗓𑗔𑗕𑗖𑗗𑗘𑗙𑗚𑗛𑗜𑗝𑗞𑗟𑗠𑗡𑗢𑗣𑗤𑗥𑗦𑗧𑗨𑗩𑗪𑗫𑗬𑗭𑗮𑗯𑗰𑗱𑗲𑗳𑗴𑗵𑗶𑗷𑗸𑗹𑗺𑗻𑗼𑗽𑗾𑗿𑘀𑘁𑘂𑘃𑘄𑘅𑘆𑘇𑘈𑘉𑘊𑘋𑘌𑘍𑘎𑘏𑘐𑘑𑘒𑘓𑘔𑘕𑘖𑘗𑘘𑘙𑘚𑘛𑘜𑘝𑘞𑘟𑘠𑘡𑘢𑘣𑘤𑘥𑘦𑘧𑘨𑘩𑘪𑘫𑘬𑘭𑘮𑘯𑘰𑘱𑘲𑘳𑘴𑘵𑘶𑘷𑘸𑘹𑘺𑘻𑘼𑘽𑘾𑘿𑙀𑙁𑙂𑙃𑙄𑙅𑙆𑙇𑙈𑙉𑙊𑙋𑙌𑙍𑙎𑙏𑙐𑙑𑙒𑙓𑙔𑙕𑙖𑙗𑙘𑙙𑙚𑙛𑙜𑙝𑙞𑙟𑙠𑙡𑙢𑙣𑙤𑙥𑙦𑙧𑙨𑙩𑙪𑙫𑙬𑙭𑙮𑙯𑙰𑙱𑙲𑙳𑙴𑙵𑙶𑙷𑙸𑙹𑙺𑙻𑙼𑙽𑙾𑙿𑚀𑚁𑚂𑚃𑚄𑚅𑚆𑚇𑚈𑚉𑚊𑚋𑚌𑚍𑚎𑚏𑚐𑚑𑚒𑚓𑚔𑚕𑚖𑚗𑚘𑚙𑚚𑚛𑚜𑚝𑚞𑚟𑚠𑚡𑚢𑚣𑚤𑚥𑚦𑚧𑚨𑚩𑚪𑚫𑚬𑚭𑚮𑚯𑚰𑚱𑚲𑚳𑚴𑚵𑚷𑚶𑚸𑚹𑚺𑚻𑚼𑚽𑚾𑚿𑛀𑛁𑛂𑛃𑛄𑛅𑛆𑛇𑛈𑛉𑛊𑛋𑛌𑛍𑛎𑛏𑛐𑛑𑛒𑛓𑛔𑛕𑛖𑛗𑛘𑛙𑛚𑛛𑛜𑛝𑛞𑛟𑛠𑛡𑛢𑛣𑛤𑛥𑛦𑛧𑛨𑛩𑛪𑛫𑛬𑛭𑛮𑛯𑛰𑛱𑛲𑛳𑛴𑛵𑛶𑛷𑛸𑛹𑛺𑛻𑛼𑛽𑛾𑛿𑜀𑜁𑜂𑜃𑜄𑜅𑜆𑜇𑜈𑜉𑜊𑜋𑜌𑜍𑜎𑜏𑜐𑜑𑜒𑜓𑜔𑜕𑜖𑜗𑜘𑜙𑜚𑜛𑜜𑜝𑜞𑜟𑜠𑜡𑜢𑜣𑜤𑜥𑜦𑜧𑜨𑜩𑜪𑜫𑜬𑜭𑜮𑜯𑜰𑜱𑜲𑜳𑜴𑜵𑜶𑜷𑜸𑜹𑜺𑜻𑜼𑜽𑜾𑜿𑝀𑝁𑝂𑝃𑝄𑝅𑝆𑝇𑝈𑝉𑝊𑝋𑝌𑝍𑝎𑝏𑝐𑝑𑝒𑝓𑝔𑝕𑝖𑝗𑝘𑝙𑝚𑝛𑝜𑝝𑝞𑝟𑝠𑝡𑝢𑝣𑝤𑝥𑝦𑝧𑝨𑝩𑝪𑝫𑝬𑝭𑝮𑝯𑝰𑝱𑝲𑝳𑝴𑝵𑝶𑝷𑝸𑝹𑝺𑝻𑝼𑝽𑝾𑝿𑞀𑞁𑞂𑞃𑞄𑞅𑞆𑞇𑞈𑞉𑞊𑞋𑞌𑞍𑞎𑞏𑞐𑞑𑞒𑞓𑞔𑞕𑞖𑞗𑞘𑞙𑞚𑞛𑞜𑞝𑞞𑞟𑞠𑞡𑞢𑞣𑞤𑞥𑞦𑞧𑞨𑞩𑞪𑞫𑞬𑞭𑞮𑞯𑞰𑞱𑞲𑞳𑞴𑞵𑞶𑞷𑞸𑞹𑞺𑞻𑞼𑞽𑞾𑞿𑟀𑟁𑟂𑟃𑟄𑟅𑟆𑟇𑟈𑟉𑟊𑟋𑟌𑟍𑟎𑟏𑟐𑟑𑟒𑟓𑟔𑟕𑟖𑟗𑟘𑟙𑟚𑟛𑟜𑟝𑟞𑟟𑟠𑟡𑟢𑟣𑟤𑟥𑟦𑟧𑟨𑟩𑟪𑟫𑟬𑟭𑟮𑟯𑟰𑟱𑟲𑟳𑟴𑟵𑟶𑟷𑟸𑟹𑟺𑟻𑟼𑟽𑟾𑟿𑠀𑠁𑠂𑠃𑠄𑠅𑠆𑠇𑠈𑠉𑠊𑠋𑠌𑠍𑠎𑠏𑠐𑠑𑠒𑠓𑠔𑠕𑠖𑠗𑠘𑠙𑠚𑠛𑠜𑠝𑠞𑠟𑠠𑠡𑠢𑠣𑠤𑠥𑠦𑠧𑠨𑠩𑠪𑠫𑠬𑠭𑠮𑠯𑠰𑠱𑠲𑠳𑠴𑠵𑠶𑠷𑠸𑠺𑠹𑠻𑠼𑠽𑠾𑠿𑡀𑡁𑡂𑡃𑡄𑡅𑡆𑡇𑡈𑡉𑡊𑡋𑡌𑡍𑡎𑡏𑡐𑡑𑡒𑡓𑡔𑡕𑡖𑡗𑡘𑡙𑡚𑡛𑡜𑡝𑡞𑡟𑡠𑡡𑡢𑡣𑡤𑡥𑡦𑡧𑡨𑡩𑡪𑡫𑡬𑡭𑡮𑡯𑡰𑡱𑡲𑡳𑡴𑡵𑡶𑡷𑡸𑡹𑡺𑡻𑡼𑡽𑡾𑡿𑢀𑢁𑢂𑢃𑢄𑢅𑢆𑢇𑢈𑢉𑢊𑢋𑢌𑢍𑢎𑢏𑢐𑢑𑢒𑢓𑢔𑢕𑢖𑢗𑢘𑢙𑢚𑢛𑢜𑢝𑢞𑢟𑢠𑢡𑢢𑢣𑢤𑢥𑢦𑢧𑢨𑢩𑢪𑢫𑢬𑢭𑢮𑢯𑢰𑢱𑢲𑢳𑢴𑢵𑢶𑢷𑢸𑢹𑢺𑢻𑢼𑢽𑢾𑢿𑣀𑣁𑣂𑣃𑣄𑣅𑣆𑣇𑣈𑣉𑣊𑣋𑣌𑣍𑣎𑣏𑣐𑣑𑣒𑣓𑣔𑣕𑣖𑣗𑣘𑣙𑣚𑣛𑣜𑣝𑣞𑣟𑣠𑣡𑣢𑣣𑣤𑣥𑣦𑣧𑣨𑣩𑣪𑣫𑣬𑣭𑣮𑣯𑣰𑣱𑣲𑣳𑣴𑣵𑣶𑣷𑣸𑣹𑣺𑣻𑣼𑣽𑣾𑣿𑤀𑤁𑤂𑤃𑤄𑤅𑤆𑤇𑤈𑤉𑤊𑤋𑤌𑤍𑤎𑤏𑤐𑤑𑤒𑤓𑤔𑤕𑤖𑤗𑤘𑤙𑤚𑤛𑤜𑤝𑤞𑤟𑤠𑤡𑤢𑤣𑤤𑤥𑤦𑤧𑤨𑤩𑤪𑤫𑤬𑤭𑤮𑤯𑤰𑤱𑤲𑤳𑤴𑤵𑤶𑤷𑤸𑤹𑤺𑤻𑤼𑤽𑤾𑤿𑥀𑥁𑥂𑥃𑥄𑥅𑥆𑥇𑥈𑥉𑥊𑥋𑥌𑥍𑥎𑥏𑥐𑥑𑥒𑥓𑥔𑥕𑥖𑥗𑥘𑥙𑥚𑥛𑥜𑥝𑥞𑥟𑥠𑥡𑥢𑥣𑥤𑥥𑥦𑥧𑥨𑥩𑥪𑥫𑥬𑥭𑥮𑥯𑥰𑥱𑥲𑥳𑥴𑥵𑥶𑥷𑥸𑥹𑥺𑥻𑥼𑥽𑥾𑥿𑦀𑦁𑦂𑦃𑦄𑦅𑦆𑦇𑦈𑦉𑦊𑦋𑦌𑦍𑦎𑦏𑦐𑦑𑦒𑦓𑦔𑦕𑦖𑦗𑦘𑦙𑦚𑦛𑦜𑦝𑦞𑦟𑦠𑦡𑦢𑦣𑦤𑦥𑦦

- The term rendered "food to be devoured" in the opening line translates a compressed phrase literally meaning "conceived of as something to be eaten," evoking the fierce visualization of devouring the three worlds, standard in wrathful fire-offering practice.

The phrase "the two faculties joined in union" refers to the union of wisdom and method, or alternatively to the two eyes or two hands fixed in union posture; the tantric context here most likely intends the former, though a sexual-yogic reading is also possible in Vairavāna context.

The passage listing bodily substances for fire offering and the final instruction to "eat and offer them always" reflects antinomian outer or inner tantric practice. The translation preserves the literal sense without softening.

"Kegpu" in the new chapter opening is a Tibetan term for a type of obstacle-being; rendered as "obstacles" in the translation for clarity.

• The term 無子 literally means "neuter" or "androgynous being" but in context here functions to indicate barren or childless women; the passage pairs it with 無女 ("barren woman" or "woman without children"), so the translation renders both as distinct categories of women who lack children, which reflects the standard understanding in the commentarial tradition.

The deity names in this passage — Uṣṇīṣa Tejas Skandha, Uṣṇīṣarāja, Uṣṇīṣa Samaya Caryāvān, Nāma Uṣṇīṣa Vikīrṇa, Uṣṇīṣa Vijaya — are compound epithets formed from the Tibetan and represent uṣṇīṣa deities in the Yamāntaka cycle; they are rendered as best reconstructed Sanskrit equivalents consistent with the textual context.

The final passage ends mid-description, breaking off as the text continues; no content has been added or completed beyond what the source supplies.

- The phrase rendered "the two roots above and in front" translates "འོག་གཞི་གཉིས་ཀྱི་མཆོག་ཀྱི་མཆོག་" and refers to tantric physiological channels; the precise anatomical referent is left deliberately cryptic in the source text as is standard in such contexts.

The syllable JA (Tibetan: འཇམ) is a seed-syllable used as a mantra of invocation and arousal; the passage shifts here into instructions for a subtle-body practice involving the movement of the bindu through the central and subsidiary channels.

The phrase "satisfy him and receive it perfectly" in the final verse is slightly elliptical in the Tibetan; the sense is that one should please the teacher and receive this teaching correctly from him.

- The ritual described in the first section is a wrathful tantric rite of destruction directed against one who has violated samaya by reviling the guru. The text's statement that the perpetrator "will be born as a buddha" through this rite reflects a standard tantric doctrinal claim that wrathful liberation (Tib. bsgral ba) actually benefits the consciousness of the one destroyed by transferring them to a higher rebirth, thus the ritual is framed as compassionate rather than merely punitive.

The list of tantras in the second section presents numerical colophon-style syllable or section counts. Several titles in this list are known canonical texts, including Guhyasamāja and Vajramālā; others appear to be titles specific to this tantra cycle. The phrase rendered "one hundred thousand, one hundred thousand and seven" (brgya stong brgya stong bdun) is an unusual formulation and may indicate a compound numerical title or count; the exact figure is ambiguous.

The term rendered "five heavy ones" (lci Inga) likely refers to the five heavy or weighty substances associated with tantric feast practice; the precise referent within this ritual context is not entirely transparent from the text alone.

- The phrase rendered "hell of the heaped-up" translates a Tibetan term that appears to denote a specific hell realm associated with being compressed or crushed without respite. The precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain; it may correspond to a hell described in tantric literature but is not one of the standard eight hot hells. This is noted as a genuinely uncertain identification.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text as provided, indicating the translation breaks off where the Tibetan input ends.

The fourteen items listed as "uncommon root downfalls" are the standard fourteen root tantric downfalls known from the tradition of the Kālacakra and related tantras, here enumerated in verse form. The instruction that they are "not to be abandoned or discarded" reflects the tantric hermeneutic that these are the commitments by which accomplishment is gained, not precepts to be dismissed, and the list that follows enumerates them positively as transgressions to avoid.

- This passage is one of the most challenging in the Indo-Tibetan tantric corpus from a doctrinal and ethical standpoint. The section beginning "likewise, one should slay sentient

beings" through "one should also speak false words" is a standard example of deliberate antinomian or "coded" (sandhyābhāṣā) tantric language. Traditional commentators uniformly interpret these injunctions as referring to inner yogic practices or symbolic actions rather than literal physical acts. The translator has rendered the words literally as the text demands, since the context is a recitation text; doctrinal commentary is properly the province of the guru-student relationship, not the translation itself.

The term rendered "zombie" is a translation of ro lang chen mo, literally "great risen corpse," referring to the vetāla (animated corpse) sādhana well known in late Indian tantra. The chapter colophon names the source text as the Śrī Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra Tantra.

The phrase rendered "born at the first of the waters" is genuinely ambiguous; it may refer to a birth sign, a lunar mansion, or a calendrical designation. The uncertainty is noted here.

- The phrase rendered "holds the hare" is a conventional way of referring to one who holds or grasps the moon, since the moon is called "the one bearing the hare" in Sanskrit cosmology. The precise ritual-technical sense here may be that the conditional ācārya is the one who introduces the disciple to the moon-disc visualization or lunar gnosis, but the literal image is preserved.

The expression "take the essence" in the risen-corpse section renders a technical term for the rasāyana-style practice of absorbing a subtle vital essence or elixir, a common motif in tantric siddhi literature.

The passage "knowing the ten suchnesses" likely refers to the ten tattvas or ten aspects of reality recognized in certain Vajrayāna systems, but the specific enumeration is not given in this passage.

- The passage on the four types of women — Hastinī, Śaṅkhinī, Kamalā, and Citrā — is a standard Tantric classification found in several Yoginī-tantra and related texts. The physiological and gustatory descriptions including "blood-taste" and "white liquor" are characteristic Vajrayāna inner-offering terminology and should be understood in that ritual-symbolic context rather than literally.

The phrase rendered "within the range of a cow's diet" for "ba lang bza' ni mda' yi nang" is literally awkward and somewhat obscure. The Tibetan reads literally "within the arrow's range of what cattle eat," which may be an idiomatic expression for a specific measurement or context; this is a genuinely uncertain phrase.

The numerical passage concerning parts, petals, and bindus is a technical Tantric instruction on maṇḍala geometry or subtle-body visualization that is deliberately cryptic. The translation preserves the literal sense without interpretive smoothing, in keeping with the tantra's esoteric register.

- The colophon verse "This is the delight of the Sugatas, the makers of bliss. You have gone forth from this" closes chapter fifteen and continues directly from the preceding passage's verse; it functions as a coda to the transmission just given.

The phrase rendered "the yoga of the mad one" translates smyon pa'i rnal 'byor, a recognized technical term in tantric literature referring to unconventional, non-conformist conduct as a means of realization; the translation preserves the literal sense without domesticating it.

"Examine discerningly for as long as it takes" renders the somewhat compressed so sor brtag, meaning individualized or analytical examination; the sense is sustained discernment practice in the state of non-self.

- The verse line rendered "Vairocana — touching, stroking, and the supreme rapture" translates a difficult sequence: "Vairocana, experiencing, touching/stroking, and the supreme

rapture." The term rendered "experiencing" could also mean "tasting" or "savoring" in a tantric sense; the precise referent of Vairocana here may indicate the deity or a visionary experience, and the line as a whole is densely technical tantric language whose exact import depends on the broader ritual context of the tantra.

The passage enumerating "the vowels and consonants" and the "two aspects of the moon" refers to the Sanskrit phonemic system used in tantric visualization, where the vowels (āli) and consonants (kāli) are correlated with subtle-body practices; this is standard Indo-Tibetan tantric scholasticism and is rendered literally here.

The final portion of the passage is clearly the opening of a new enumeration that continues beyond this excerpt.

- The phrase rendered "the fortyfold teaching" translates a term literally meaning "the meaning of the forty," which likely refers to a specific enumeration of forty points within this tantra's system; the exact referent is not specified in this passage and may require consultation of a commentary.

The "five secrets" is a standard Vajrayāna technical term referring to the five secret aspects of the body of a buddha or of tantric practice; the precise referent may vary by lineage and is not elaborated here.

The colophon names the place of origin as Oḍḍiyāna, the legendary tantric land traditionally identified with the Swat Valley region.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.